

BRICKSTransaction Server

Application Programming Reference

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Document

Bricks Application Programming Reference

Audience

Application programmers writing REXX or COBOL transactions for Bricks.

Companion

README.md — installation, configuration, and operations.

Operator manual

ISPF_editor.md — the in-3270 source editor reference.

About this publication

This reference describes the application-programming interface of the **Bricks Transaction Server**: the COBOL and REXX languages it accepts, the EXEC CICS command set those programs may issue, the EXEC SQL embedded database surface, the EXEC CICS WEB command family for HTTP service, the BMS-flavoured map DSL used to build 3270 panels, the VSAM and temporary-storage queue surfaces, and the catalogue of sample programs shipped under runtime/.

Operational and installation topics — running bricks, editing bricks.cnf, signing on through CSSN, the CEMT master terminal, the bricksload stress tester, and the /metrics endpoint — are documented in the companion **README.md**.

Who should read this publication

This manual is for application programmers who write transactions that run under Bricks. Familiarity with the IBM CICS programming model (pseudo-conversational dispatch, the **EIB**, **COM-MAREA**, BMS maps, KSDS files, temporary-storage queues, the SQLCA, and embedded SQL) is assumed. Where Bricks deviates from the IBM behaviour the difference is documented explicitly.

Conventions used in this publication

The following notational conventions appear throughout the manual.

Symbol	Meaning
UPPERCASE	A keyword. Coded literally.
lowercase	A value supplied by the programmer (a name or expression).
[]	An optional clause.

Symbol	Meaning
{ a b }	A required choice between alternatives.
...	The preceding clause may repeat.

Command syntax is shown in the EXEC CICS ... END-EXEC form. The bare-string form ("VERB OPTIONS" under ADDRESS CICS, REXX only) is described in *Chapter 2. The EXEC CICS command environment*; both forms dispatch identically.

Reference layout

Each command described in this manual follows the same five-section layout, in this order:

1. **Format** — the command syntax as a code block.
2. **Description** — what the command does and any important runtime behaviour.
3. **Options** — every keyword that follows the verb, with its meaning and any value constraints.
4. **Conditions** — the EIBRESP values (or SQLCODE values, for EXEC SQL) the command may return, together with the cause of each.
5. **Example** — a short, runnable fragment illustrating typical use.

Programming Note. Where the same verb behaves differently in COBOL and in REXX, the difference is called out in a *Programming Note* like this one. Where both languages share identical behaviour, the example uses whichever form reads most clearly.

Contents

This publication is organised into nine parts, an appendix series, and a quick-reference card. Read **Part 1** first; the remaining parts are reference material consulted as needed.

Part 1. Bricks programming principles

- Chapter 1. Overview
- Chapter 2. The EXEC CICS command environment
- Chapter 3. The map DSL

Part 2. The COBOL language

- Chapter 20. COBOL source format
- Chapter 21. DATA DIVISION
- Chapter 22. PROCEDURE DIVISION
- Chapter 23. The EIB block in COBOL
- Chapter 24. EXEC CICS in COBOL
- Chapter 25. Copybooks
- Chapter 27. Restrictions and deferred features

Part 3. The REXX language

- Chapter 14. REXX program structure

- Chapter 15. Variables and stems
- Chapter 16. Control flow
- Chapter 17. PARSE templates
- Chapter 18. Conditions and SIGNAL ON
- Chapter 19. Built-in functions

Part 4. EXEC CICS command reference

- Chapter 4. Terminal I/O commands — SEND MAP, RECEIVE MAP, CONVERSE, SEND TEXT, RECEIVE
- Chapter 5. Program control commands — RETURN, XCTL, LINK, ABEND, START, RETRIEVE
- Chapter 6. System services — ASSIGN, ASKTIME, FORMATTIME
- Chapter 10. Recovery and condition handling — SYNCPOINT, SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK, HANDLE CONDITION, IGNORE CONDITION, HANDLE AID, HANDLE ABEND
- Chapter 11. The Execute Interface Block (EIB)
- Chapter 12. Response codes
- Chapter 13. Commands not implemented

Part 5. EXEC CICS file and queue commands

VSAM-style KSDS files and temporary-storage / transient-data queues.

- Chapter 7. KSDS file commands — READ, WRITE, REWRITE, DELETE
- Chapter 8. KSDS browse commands — STARTBR, READNEXT, READPREV, RESETBR, ENDBR
- Chapter 9. Temporary storage and transient data commands — READQ TS/TD, WRITEQ TS/TD, DELETEQ TS/TD, the tmp_dir sandbox

Part 6. EXEC SQL command reference

- Chapter 26. Embedded SQL (COBOL and REXX) — SELECT INTO, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE, COMMIT, ROLLBACK, CONNECT TO, cursors (DECLARE / OPEN / FETCH / CLOSE), WHENEVER, null indicators, the SQLCA, the SQLCODE catalogue, SYNCPOINT integration.

Part 7. EXEC CICS WEB command reference

- EXEC CICS WEB — server side
- EXEC CICS WEB — client side
- EXEC CICS DOCUMENT — chunked body builder
- EXEC CICS WEB — Phase 3b additions

Part 8. Sample programs

- Chapter 28. Pre-installed sample transactions
- Chapter 29. Worked examples

Appendixes

- Appendix A. Adapting to terminal size (mod 2 vs mod 4)
- Appendix B. Pitfalls and idioms
- Appendix C. Quick command reference card

Note on physical order. The chapter numbers in this contents list are the canonical numbers used throughout the publication. Because some parts have been re-ordered into the logical grouping above, a chapter you find on Part 4 of the contents may sit physically later in the file than a chapter listed in Part 5. Cross-references everywhere in the manual use the chapter number, not the file position.

Part 1. The bricks programming model

Chapter 1. Overview

A bricks **transaction** is a 4-character TRANSID listed in `runtime/transactions.conf`. Each transaction names a **program** — either a REXX source file in `runtime/rexx/` or a COBOL source file in `runtime/cobol/` — and an optional access-control list:

```
HEL0:rexx:hello.rexx
HELP:rexx:help.rexx:public
QAGE:rexx:qage.rexx:public,users,admin
HELC:cobol:hello.cob:public
GUST:cobol:gust.cob:public
```

Organising programs into sub-directories

Once a deployment grows past a handful of programs, the flat `runtime/rexx/` / `runtime/cobol/` layout becomes hard to scan. You can group programs into sub-directories at any depth and reference them with a relative path from the language root:

```
runtime/cobol/billing/invoice.cob
runtime/cobol/billing/statement.cob
runtime/cobol/cards/visa/authz.cob
runtime/rexx/admin/userprov.rexx

INVC:cobol:billing/invoice.cob:public
STMT:cobol:billing/statement.cob:public
AUTH:cobol:cards/visa/authz.cob:admin
USRP:rexx:admin/userprov.rexx:admin
```

Forward slashes work on both POSIX and Windows. `CEDA PROGRAM` walks the language roots recursively and shows each file with its relative path (so `billing/invoice.cob` appears in the **FILE** column, matching what you write in `transactions.conf`). `CEMT INQUIRE TRANSACTION` shows the same form in the **PROGRAM** column, eliding a long middle (`billing/.../authz.cob`) so the leading application and the file basename always stay visible. Hidden entries (dotfile-prefixed, e.g. `.git/`, `.swp` files) are skipped during the catalogue walk; recursion is capped at 8 levels.

`CEDA TRANSACTION` accepts a relative subdirectory path in the **PROGRAM** form field. `..` traversal is rejected; so are empty path segments (`a//b.rexx`). Absolute paths are accepted unchanged for the rare case of running one-off programs from outside the runtime tree.

`brickscompile` accepts either a single file or a directory. In directory mode it walks recursively (same depth cap + hidden-skip rules as `CEDA PROGRAM`) and reports per-file pass/fail; exit code is 0 only if every file parses cleanly.

Program caching

The first time a TRANSID is dispatched, its program is parsed and the AST is cached (see *Parsed-program cache* in the README); subsequent dispatches skip the parse. Each running task has its own heap and stack — there is no shared mutable state between concurrently running tasks of the same TRANSID.

Programs interact with three layers:

1. **The 3270 terminal**, through EXEC CICS SEND MAP / RECEIVE MAP (and the unstructured SEND TEXT / RECEIVE pairing). Maps are defined in the BMS-style DSL described in Chapter 3.
2. **Persistent data**, through KSDS file commands (Chapter 7) and TS-queue commands (Chapter 9). Both are backed by an embedded bbolt B+tree at `data/files.boltdb`.
3. **Other programs**, through LINK (synchronous, with COMMAREA), XCTL (transfer of control, no return), and RETURN TRANSID (pseudo-conversational chaining). The Execute Interface Block (EIB) exposes session and request state (Chapter 11).

REXX and COBOL share **the same EXEC CICS dispatcher** (`cics/handler.go`). Every command documented in Part 2 is therefore available, with identical syntax and identical semantics, from either language.

A typical pseudo-conversational task has the shape:

ADDRESS CICS

```
EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP('CUST1')          END-EXEC  /* read prior screen */
... validate / compute ...
EXEC CICS SEND    MAP('CUST1') FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC
EXEC CICS RETURN  TRANSID('CUST')       END-EXEC  /* chain back to self */
```

The dispatcher invokes the program once per ENTER. State that must survive between invocations rides in the COMMAREA on RETURN; the chained task receives it through EIBCALEN and the DFHCOMMAREA data area.

Chapter 2. The EXEC CICS command environment

Surface forms

Bricks accepts two equivalent surface forms inside an ADDRESS CICS scope.

1. **IBM-canonical EXEC CICS ... END-EXEC** — the form CICS programmers recognize. Available from REXX and COBOL.

ADDRESS CICS

```
EXEC CICS ASSIGN  USERID(USR) TERMID(TRM)      END-EXEC
EXEC CICS SEND    MAP('HEL01') FROM(SCR.) ERASE  END-EXEC
EXEC CICS RETURN                                     END-EXEC
```

In REXX, a small preprocessor (`rexx/preprocess.go`, called from `rexx.Parse`) rewrites each EXEC CICS ... END-EXEC block into the equivalent quoted-string command before lexing. Multi-line bodies

are collapsed into a single command string; trailing newlines preserve source line numbers in error messages. Comments and string literals are left alone.

In COBOL, the parser collects every token between EXEC CICS and END-EXEC and reconstructs the body verbatim for the same `cics.ParseCommand` REXX uses.

2. Bare string under ADDRESS CICS — terser; available **only in REXX**.

```
ADDRESS CICS
"ASSIGN USERID(USR) TERMID(TRM)"
"SEND MAP('HEL01') FROM(SCR.) ERASE"
"RETURN"
```

Both forms route through `cics.ParseCommand` and dispatch to the same handler. After every command the handler writes EIBRESP, EIBRESP2, and RC into the program's frame.

Argument-passing rules

Inside the parentheses of an option:

- A bare identifier is treated as a **variable name**. The handler reads the value at runtime, and (where the option is an output) writes the result back into that variable.
- A quoted string literal ('...' or "...") is treated as a **literal value**. The handler does not write to literals; passing a literal to an output-only option is rejected with INVREQ.

This distinction matters most for length and key fields: `LENGTH(LEN)` both reads the requested length on input and writes the actual length back; `LENGTH(80)` only sets the input length.

Programming model summary

Concept	Bricks implementation
Task	One invocation of one TRANSID (<code>session.TxCB</code>).
Program	A parsed REXX or COBOL source file, cached at L1/L2.
Pseudo-conversational chain	EXEC CICS RETURN TRANSID(t) COMMAREA(d).
Conversational	Loop in the program; each RECEIVE MAP blocks on input.
Inter-program call	LINK PROGRAM(name) COMMAREA(var) (synchronous).
Storage shared across tasks	KSDS files, TS queues.
Storage shared within one task	REXX variables / COBOL WORKING-STORAGE only.
Implicit task end	Program runs off the end, or STOP RUN (COBOL).
Forced task end	EXEC CICS ABEND.

Chapter 3. The map DSL

Bricks ships its own line-oriented, BMS-flavoured map DSL (parsed by `mapdsl/`). Maps live as `*.map` files in the directory configured by `maps_dir` (default `runtime/map/`). Each file contains one or more `MAP ... ENDMAP` blocks. Comments start with `*`.

Format

```
MAP <name> SIZE rowsxcols
  [FIELD AT r,c LEN n <attrs> "literal"]
  [INPUT <fieldname> AT r,c LEN n <attrs> [DEFAULT "value"]]
  [STOP AT r,c]
  [CURSOR AT {fieldname | r,c}]
ENDMAP
```

Statements

MAP <name> SIZE rowsxcols The map header. Names must be unique across the directory (case-insensitive); typical sizes are `24x80` (mod 2) and `43x80` (mod 4).

FIELD AT r,c LEN n <attrs> "literal" A display-only field that paints the literal at row `r`, column `c`, length `n`. Useful for labels, headings, and panel chrome.

INPUT <fieldname> AT r,c LEN n <attrs> [DEFAULT "value"] A named input field. The name is how `SEND MAP FROM(STEM.)` and `RECEIVE MAP INTO(STEM.)` route data to / from this position (`STEM.<fieldname>`). Use `PROT` to make the field write-protected but still named — useful for output values painted by `SEND MAP FROM(STEM.)`.

STOP AT r,c An autoskip stop attribute that ends the preceding input field.

CURSOR AT <fieldname> or CURSOR AT r,c The home position for the cursor when the map is sent. The named form resolves to `(field.Row, field.Col + 1)` — i.e. one byte to the right of the leading 3270 attribute byte, which is the writable cell. Forward references are allowed; names are resolved after the whole map is parsed. When omitted, the renderer falls back to the first input field.

ENDMAP Terminates the map.

Converting legacy BMS sources

The `bricksconvert` CLI utility (under `cmd/bricksconvert`) converts IBM CICS **BMS map source** (`DFHMSD` / `DFHMDI` / `DFHMDF` macros) into this DSL — the recommended path for porting an existing CICS application's screens onto bricks without rewriting every panel by hand. See the BMS conversion section in the README for usage details.

Attributes

`PROT`, `UNPROT`, `BRIGHT`, `DIM`, `UNDERSCORE`, `HIDDEN`, `NUMERIC`, `MDT`, `BLINK`, `REVERSE`, `COLOR=BLUE|RED|PINK|GREEN|TURQUOISE|V`

Catalogue lifecycle

`mapdsl.NewCatalog(dir)` parses every `*.map` file at startup and self-refreshes on subsequent edits. Each `Lookup(name)` stats the directory plus the source file backing the requested name; on `mtime`

change the directory is reparsed and swapped atomically. A failed re-parse keeps the prior catalogue in place — the operator can find the broken file with CEMT PERFORM RESCAN MAP (see the README).

Example

```
* CICS sign-on screen
MAP CSSN SIZE 24x80
  FIELD AT 1,28 LEN 24 PROT BRIGHT COLOR=TURQUOISE  "BRICKS SIGN-ON"
  FIELD AT 6,15 LEN 9  PROT                          "Userid:"
  INPUT USERID   AT 6,25 LEN 8 UNDERSCORE COLOR=GREEN
  STOP          AT 6,34
  FIELD AT 8,15 LEN 9  PROT                          "Password:"
  INPUT PASSWORD AT 8,25 LEN 8 HIDDEN UNDERSCORE COLOR=RED
  STOP          AT 8,34
  CURSOR        AT USERID
ENDMAP
```

Part 4. EXEC CICS command reference

Part 4 begins here. This part documents the core non-file, non-SQL, non-WEB EXEC CICS verbs. File and queue commands are in **Part 5**; EXEC SQL is in **Part 6**; EXEC CICS WEB is in **Part 7**.

This part documents every EXEC CICS command bricks implements. Each command page follows the same layout: **Format, Description, Options, Conditions, Example**.

Commands are grouped by function:

- Chapter 4. Terminal I/O
- Chapter 5. Program control
- Chapter 6. System services
- Chapter 7. KSDS files
- Chapter 8. KSDS browse
- Chapter 9. Temporary storage

Cross-cutting reference:

- Chapter 10. Recovery and condition handling
 - Chapter 11. The EIB
 - Chapter 12. Response codes
 - Chapter 13. Commands not implemented
-

Chapter 4. Terminal I/O commands

SEND MAP

Send a BMS-style map to the 3270 terminal and wait for the operator to press an AID key.

Format

```
EXEC CICS SEND MAP(name)
          [FROM(stem.)]
          [ERASE | DATAONLY]
          [CURSOR(position)]
```

END-EXEC

Description Loads the named map from the catalogue, populates each named field with the value of <stem>.<fieldname> (when **FROM** is supplied), paints the screen, and waits for the operator to press an AID key (ENTER, PF_n, PA_n, CLEAR). On return, the captured response is stored on the TCB so a subsequent **RECEIVE MAP** can pull modified field values back into the program. **EIBAID** and **EIBCP0SN** are updated with the AID character and 1-based cursor position.

If **FROM** is omitted, the map renders using its **INPUT DEFAULT** values. If **FROM** is a literal string, every named field on the map is filled with that literal (rare; supported for parity with BMS).

Three paint modes

Flag	Field set	Blocking?	When to use
ERASE	Every field in the map	Yes — waits for AID	Initial paint, full refresh.
(neither)	Only fields the program populated in FROM(stem)	Yes — waits for AID	In-place update inside a conversational loop (rare; usually ERASE is fine).
DATAONLY	Only fields the program populated in FROM(stem)	No — returns immediately	Background refresh while a different task is mid-input.

ERASE clears the screen first and emits **every** field in the map (with either the program's **FROM** value or the map default). Without **ERASE**, bricks does a **partial repaint**: only fields the program explicitly populated in **FROM(stem)** are sent; fields the program didn't touch stay on the terminal exactly as the operator left them. Use **ERASE** for the initial paint of a screen or a full refresh; omit it for in-place partial updates.

DATAONLY — background partial paint **DATAONLY** is the bricks idiom for **background, fire-and-forget partial paint**, used to refresh part of the screen — typically a clock or other status fields — while a different task on the same terminal is blocking inside **SEND MAP** waiting for the operator's next keystroke. It layers two things on top of the plain no-**ERASE** partial-paint behaviour:

1. **No-block:** **DATAONLY** makes **SEND MAP** return immediately after writing the screen, without entering the AID-wait. The call is fire-and-forget — the operator's next AID is captured by whatever other **SEND MAP** or **RECEIVE MAP** happens to be blocking for it.
2. **Scheduler-safe:** when an **EXEC CICS START INTERVAL(...)** timer fires on a terminal whose current task is in input-wait, the bricks scheduler dispatches the queued task **inline** in the timer goroutine instead of poisoning the conn read deadline (which would abend the in-flight task with an i/o timeout). The inline-dispatched task is restricted to write-only verbs: **SEND**

MAP DATAONLY, file I/O, TS queue, ASSIGN, START. Any blocking verb (RECEIVE MAP, SEND MAP without DATAONLY, CONVERSE) returns INVREQ in that context — the scheduler goroutine must not block on conn.Read.

This together lets a transaction self-schedule a periodic refresh via:

```
EXEC CICS START TRANSID('CHAT') INTERVAL(000002) FROM('TICK') END-EXEC
EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
```

When the START fires, the same transaction is dispatched a second time. The dispatched copy detects “I am a tick” by checking the RETRIEVE payload, paints only the fields it wants to refresh (SEND MAP ... DATAONLY — the operator’s input field is not in the populated set, so it’s never repainted), schedules the next tick, and returns. The main task on the same terminal stays blocked in its outer SEND MAP throughout. See runtime/rexx/chat.rexx for the worked example.

DATAONLY and ERASE are mutually exclusive — the runtime rejects the combination at parse time. Note: bricks does not implement the real-CICS DATAONLY attribute-byte semantics (application-supplied attribute bytes via X'00' sentinels); programs that need a synchronous partial repaint use the plain no-ERASE form, and programs that need a background refresh use DATAONLY with the START-INTERVAL pattern above.

Options MAP(name) — *required* Name of a map in the catalogue (case-insensitive). MAPFAIL if absent.

FROM(stem.) Stem variable whose tails name the map’s input fields. The stem’s trailing dot is optional: FROM(SCR) and FROM(SCR.) are equivalent.

ERASE Clears the screen before painting AND emits every field in the map. Without this flag, only fields the program populated in FROM(stem) are sent — fields the program didn’t touch stay on the terminal unchanged (partial repaint).

DATAONLY Fire-and-forget partial paint: SEND returns immediately without waiting for an AID. Implies no-ERASE partial-repaint semantics. Mutually exclusive with ERASE.

CURSOR(position) 1-based cursor position. Overrides the map’s CURSOR AT clause.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Map sent, AID received.
MAPFAIL	36	Named map not found in the catalogue.
IOERR	17	The terminal write failed.

Example

```
SCR.GREETING = 'Hello, ' || USR
EXEC CICS SEND MAP('HEL01') FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC
```

RECEIVE MAP

Retrieve the operator's input from the most recent **SEND MAP**.

Format

```
EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP(name)
                        [INTO(stem.)]
END-EXEC
```

Description Pulls the response stored by the most recent **SEND MAP** into a stem, one tail per named field on the map (<stem>.<fieldname>). When **INTO** is omitted, the default stem is **MAP..**

A **RECEIVE MAP** with no matching prior **SEND MAP** returns **MAPFAIL**.

Options **MAP(name)** — *required* The same map name passed to the prior **SEND MAP**.

INTO(stem.) Destination stem. Default **MAP..**

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Fields retrieved.
MAPFAIL	36	No prior matching SEND MAP , or named map not found.

Example

```
EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP('CUST1') INTO(IN.) END-EXEC
ACTION = IN.ACTION
CKEY   = IN.CUSTNO
```

CONVERSE

A single verb that fuses **SEND MAP** and **RECEIVE MAP** against the same map. Semantically identical to issuing the two halves back-to-back; provided because real-world CICS programs written between the 1970s and the 1990s used **CONVERSE** heavily, and porting them shouldn't require a **SEND/RECEIVE** rewrite.

Format

```
EXEC CICS CONVERSE MAP(name) [MAPSET(set)]
                        [FROM(area) | FROMMAP(area)]
                        [INTO(area)]
                        [ERASE] [CURSOR(pos)]
END-EXEC
```

- **FROM(area)** and **FROMMAP(area)** are accepted spellings for the outbound stem; either works, both feed the **SEND** half.

- **INTO(area)** is the inbound stem; it feeds the **RECEIVE** half. May be omitted only if the program follows up with a separate **RECEIVE MAP** (rare; using **CONVERSE** without **INTO** is technically legal but defeats the point).
- **MAPSET**, **ERASE**, **CURSOR** pass through to both halves.

Behaviour **CONVERSE** issues **SEND MAP** first, then **RECEIVE MAP** against the same **MAP(name)**. If the **SEND** half returns anything other than **RESP-NORMAL**, the **RECEIVE** half is **skipped** and the **SEND**'s response code is returned — matches real CICS semantics (no screen ever made it to the terminal, so there's no operator response to wait for).

Example

```
EXEC CICS CONVERSE MAP('TIM1') FROM(SCR) INTO(SCR)
                        ERASE
END-EXEC.
IF EIBAID = PF03 THEN
    EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
END-IF.
```

This replaces the longer pair:

```
EXEC CICS SEND MAP('TIM1') FROM(SCR) ERASE END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP('TIM1') INTO(SCR)      END-EXEC.
```

Live example: `runtime/cobol/timc.cob` uses **CONVERSE** for both the input screen and the reminder screen.

SEND TEXT

Free-form text output without a BMS map.

Format

```
EXEC CICS SEND TEXT FROM(area)
                        [LENGTH(n)]
                        [ERASE]
END-EXEC
```

Description Real-CICS **SEND TEXT**. The body is treated as a flat row-major buffer: every **cols** bytes (default 80) lands on the next row, starting at row 0. **3270** has no **LF/CR**, so programs must pad each logical line to the column width and concatenate (`REXX LEFT(s,80)`, `COBOL PIC X(80)` group children).

LENGTH(n) truncates the body to *n* bytes; bytes past **rows*cols** are dropped. **ERASE** clears the screen before painting; without it, existing fields stay behind. Like **SEND MAP**, the call paints synchronously and waits for an **AID**, so the operator has time to read the screen before **RETURN**.

Works identically from **REXX** and **COBOL**.

Options **FROM(area)** — *required* The buffer to paint. Can be a REXX variable or a COBOL group item.

LENGTH(n) Truncate the body to this length.

ERASE Clear the screen first.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Body painted, AID received.
INVREQ	16	FROM missing.
IOERR	17	The terminal write failed.

Example See Chapter 29. Worked examples, the GETC program, for the canonical multi-row **SEND TEXT** pattern.

RECEIVE

Retrieve the unedited terminal line typed by the operator at the blank prompt — typically used to pick up command-line arguments.

Format

```
EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(buffer)
                        [LENGTH(len)]
END-EXEC
```

Description Returns the unedited terminal line the operator typed at the blank prompt (TRAN-**SID** prefix included), e.g. **EXAM 1 2 3**. Single-shot per task: a second **RECEIVE** in the same task, or any **RECEIVE** in a chained **RETURN TRANSID** task, returns **EOC** (**RESP**=6).

When **LENGTH(var)** is a bare variable, the actual byte count of the line is written back. The receiving COBOL field's **PIC X(n)** width handles padding/truncation via standard **MOVE** semantics; programs detect truncation by comparing **len** against **n**.

Options **INTO(buffer)** — *required* Destination variable for the line.

LENGTH(len) When a bare variable, receives the actual length on return.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Line returned.
EOC	6	No input available (already consumed in this task chain).

Example

```
EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(BUF) LENGTH(LEN) END-EXEC  /* "GETC 100" */
PARSE VAR BUF TID CKEY .

EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(WS-INPUT) LENGTH(WS-LEN) END-EXEC
UNSTRING WS-INPUT DELIMITED BY ' '
      INTO WS-TID WS-A WS-B WS-C
END-UNSTRING.
```

Chapter 5. Program control commands

RETURN

End the current task; optionally chain to another TRANSID with a COMMAREA.

Format

```
EXEC CICS RETURN [TRANSID(id)]
                  [COMMAREA(data)]
END-EXEC
```

Description Sets `tcb.NextTransid` and `tcb.Commarea` and ends the task. With no `TRANSID`, control falls back to the blank prompt. With a `TRANSID`, the dispatcher invokes that `TRANSID` next, with the supplied `COMMAREA` available to the new task as `DFHCOMMAREA` and its length as `EIBCALEN`.

Options `TRANSID(id)` The next `TRANSID` to dispatch.

`COMMAREA(data)` Bytes to flow into the next task.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Task ended.

Example

```
EXEC CICS RETURN TRANSID('CUST') COMMAREA(SAVEAREA) END-EXEC
```

XCTL

Transfer control to another program. The current program does not resume.

Format

```
EXEC CICS XCTL PROGRAM(name)
                  [COMMAREA(data)]
END-EXEC
```

Description Transfer of control. The named program runs in place of the current one; the COMMAREA, if supplied, becomes its DFHCOMMAREA. The current task's chain continues with the new program; RETURN TRANSID semantics carry through unchanged.

Options **PROGRAM(name)** — *required* The target program. Resolved through runtime/transactions.conf.

COMMAREA(data) Bytes to flow to the target.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Control transferred.
PGMIDERR	27	Target program not in transactions.conf.
INVREQ	16	PROGRAM missing.

Example

```
EXEC CICS XCTL PROGRAM('VALIDATE') COMMAREA(SCR) END-EXEC
```

LINK

Synchronously call a sub-program with bidirectional COMMAREA.

Format

```
EXEC CICS LINK PROGRAM(name)
                [COMMAREA(var | 'literal')]
END-EXEC
```

Description The target program runs in a fresh frame with its DFHCOMMAREA preloaded from the caller's COMMAREA(var) (or literal). When the sub-program exits, its final DFHCOMMAREA is written back to the caller's variable.

Caller state — NextTransid, Commarea, LastResponse, LastMapName — is saved before the LINK and restored on return, so the LINK is transparent to the caller's pseudo-conversational context.

The per-transaction ACL is rechecked on the target so a low-privilege caller cannot escalate by linking into an admin program.

REXX and COBOL programs can LINK to each other freely; DFHCOMMAREA is marshalled as opaque bytes.

Options **PROGRAM(name)** — *required* The sub-program to call. Resolved through runtime/transactions.conf.

COMMAREA(var | 'literal') Bidirectional data area. A bare variable is read on entry and written on exit; a literal is read-only.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Sub-program returned cleanly.
PGMIDERR	27	Target not in <code>transactions.conf</code> , sub-program errored, or the caller is not authorised for the target.

Example

```
SAV = ''                                /* working area */
EXEC CICS LINK PROGRAM('CUSV') COMMAREA(SAV) END-EXEC
IF EIBRESP <> 0 THEN SIGNAL ERR
PARSE VAR SAV STATUS '|' MSG
```

ABEND

Abnormally terminate the current task.

Format

```
EXEC CICS ABEND [ABCODE(code)]
                [NODUMP]
END-EXEC
```

Description Ends the task with the supplied 4-character abend code (default AAAA). Bricks logs the abend on the operator console and reflects it in the TxCB's status; pseudo-conversational chains are broken (no NextTransid is honoured after an ABEND).

Options **ABCODE(code)** 4-character code to record. Defaults to AAAA.

NODUMP Accepted for parity with IBM CICS; no dumps are produced anyway.

Conditions ABEND does not return; nothing follows it in the program flow.

Example

```
IF EIBRESP <> 0 THEN
  EXEC CICS ABEND ABCODE('FI01') END-EXEC
```

START

Schedule a transaction to fire on this same terminal after a delay (or at a wall-clock time), optionally passing a byte payload the new task picks up via RETRIEVE. This is bricks's implementation of CICS's classic deferred-work pattern: a task queues "do X in 60 seconds" and ends; the terminal returns to the blank prompt; when the timer elapses, bricks dispatches X automatically.

Format

```
EXEC CICS START TRANSID(name)
          [INTERVAL(hhmmss) | TIME(hhmmss)]
          [FROM(area) [LENGTH(n)]]
          [TERMID(tttt)]
END-EXEC
```

Options **TRANSID(name)** (*required*) 4-character transaction id, must exist in run-time/transactions.conf. The dispatcher applies the normal per-transaction ACL at fire time, so the operator must still be authorised to invoke name.

INTERVAL(hhmmss) Delay before firing, expressed as up to 6 digits in HHMMSS form (left-padded with zeroes). **INTERVAL(30)** = 30 s; **INTERVAL(000130)** = 1 min 30 s; **INTERVAL(010000)** = 1 h. Omit (or pair with **INTERVAL(0)**) to fire on the next prompt-loop iteration.

TIME(hhmmss) Absolute wall-clock target, also HHMMSS. Respects the operator's time_zone= setting. If the target is earlier than now, bricks rolls forward to the same time tomorrow (real-CICS semantics). Mutually exclusive with **INTERVAL**.

FROM(area) [LENGTH(n)] Payload bytes the new task will pull back via RETRIEVE. **LENGTH** truncates area to n bytes; if omitted, the entire string value of area is queued. The bytes are copied at **START** time, so the issuing task may mutate area afterwards without disturbing the queued payload.

TERMID(tttt) Must equal the issuing terminal's EIBTRMID in this version. Cross-terminal STARTs return RESP=INVREQ with "only same-terminal STARTs are supported."

Scope and limitations (v1)

- **Same-terminal only.** A START always fires on the issuing TCB. No-TERMID background tasks and TERMID(other) are rejected; both require infrastructure (synthetic TCBs, cross-session authorisation) that's deferred.
- **In-memory queue.** Pending STARTs do **not** survive a bricks restart. If you need recovery-protected scheduling you'll have to wait for START PROTECT (out of scope).
- **No REQID, SYSID, QUEUE, PROTECT, HOURS, MINUTES, SECONDS options.** Each returns RESP=INVREQ with the option name in the error string so a port can be triaged.
- **One pending payload per task.** When the START fires, the FROM bytes go into tcb.RetrieveBuf. The new task's first RETRIEVE drains it; a second RETRIEVE returns RESP=ENDDATA (29).

Conditions

- RESP=NORMAL on successful enqueue.

- **RESP-INVREQ** for missing **TRANSID**, cross-terminal **TERMINID**, unsupported option, or malformed **INTERVAL/TIME**.

Example

```
EXEC CICS START TRANSID('TIMC') INTERVAL('000030')
      FROM(MSG)
END-EXEC.
```

Schedules **TIMC** to fire on this terminal in 30 seconds with the contents of **MSG** queued as the payload. See `runtime/cobol/timc.cob` and `runtime/rexx/timr.rexx` for the worked examples.

RETRIEVE

Pull back the **FROM(...)** payload of the **START** that scheduled the *current* task. **RETRIEVE** is the receiving half of the **START** / **RETRIEVE** pair; the first thing a transaction fired by **START** typically does.

Format

```
EXEC CICS RETRIEVE INTO(var) [LENGTH(lenvar)] END-EXEC
```

Options **INTO(var)** (*required*) Variable / **DATA** area to receive the payload bytes. Must be a name reference, not a string literal.

LENGTH(lenvar) Optional. The variable named here is written with the actual byte length of the payload after a successful read, so the caller can size the consumer code correctly.

Behaviour

- Cold dispatch (operator typed the **TRANSID** at the prompt) → **RESP-ENDDATA** (29), nothing written to **INTO**.
- Scheduled re-entry → **RESP-NORMAL**, payload bytes copied into **INTO**, `tcb.RetrieveBuf` cleared.
- Second **RETRIEVE** in the same task → **RESP-ENDDATA** (the buffer is cleared on first read; v1 supports one pending payload per task).

Idiom The canonical **START** / **RETRIEVE** program tests **EIBRESP** first to discover *which dispatch path* it's on, then branches:

```
MOVE SPACES TO BUF.
EXEC CICS RETRIEVE INTO(BUF) END-EXEC.

IF EIBRESP = RESP-NORMAL THEN
  PERFORM SHOW-REMINDER      *> scheduled fire
  EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
END-IF.

*> Cold path: prompt the operator, schedule next fire.
PERFORM PROMPT-AND-SCHEDULE.
```

REXX equivalent in `runtime/rexx/timr.rexx`; COBOL in `runtime/cobol/timc.cob`.

Chapter 6. System services

ASSIGN

Read EIB, session, and environment fields into the program.

Format

```
EXEC CICS ASSIGN <FIELD>(target) [<FIELD>(target) ...]  
END-EXEC
```

Description Reads one or more system fields into program variables. Multiple options can be combined in a single **ASSIGN** call. Each **<FIELD>** is one of the keywords below; **target** is the variable that receives the value.

Options

Option	Returns
USERID(t)	Signed-on userid (empty until CSSN succeeds).
TERMINID(t) / EIBTRMID(t)	Unique 4-digit terminal id (T0001 ...).
EIBAID(t)	Single-byte AID character of the most recent SEND MAP / RECEIVE MAP. Compare with C2X(EIBAID) = 'F3' (REXX) or EIBAID = X'F3' (COBOL) to detect PF3, etc.
EIBCP0SN(t)	1-based cursor position from the most recent map response.
EIBCALEN(t)	Length of DFHCOMMAREA flowed in from the caller.
TWALENG(t) / TCTUALENG(t)	Always 0 (bricks does not allocate a TWA / TCTUA).
SCREENHT(t) / SCREENWD(t)	Negotiated terminal rows / columns.
ALTSCRNHT(t) / ALTSCRNWD(t)	Same values; bricks does not distinguish primary and alternate sizes.
CONNECTED(t) / CONNTIME(t)	Wall-clock connect timestamp YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM:SS.
TLS(t)	yes when the session is on the TLS listener, no otherwise.
DATE(t)	Today as YYYYMMDD. (<i>bricks-specific</i>)
TIME(t)	Now as HHMMSS. (<i>bricks-specific</i>)
TODAYYR(t) / TODAYMO(t) / TODAYDY(t)	Today's year / month / day individually. (<i>bricks-specific</i>)
DAYCOUNT(t)	Days since 1970-01-01. Subtract two values for an exact day delta. (<i>bricks-specific</i>)

The bricks-specific options exist primarily so the COBOL subset can do date math without REXX-style intrinsic functions; see `runtime/cobol/qagc.cob` for an example that computes age in years from a birthdate.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	All requested fields returned.
INVREQ	16	A field name is unknown, or its target is a literal rather than a variable.

Example

```
EXEC CICS ASSIGN USERID(USR)
                TERMID(TRM)
                SCREENHT(SCRH)
                SCREENWD(SCRW)
END-EXEC
```

ASKTIME

Refresh the EIB date/time fields and, optionally, return the current time as a 15-digit absolute timestamp (`ABSTIME`).

Format

```
EXEC CICS ASKTIME [ABSTIME(target)]
END-EXEC
```

Description `ASKTIME` re-reads the system clock and writes the current date and time into `EIBDATE` and `EIBTIME`. Both fields follow the IBM CICS formats:

- `EIBDATE` — packed-style decimal `0CYDDDD`, where `C` is (century - 19) and `YYDDD` is the two-digit year and Julian day-of-year. For 2026-05-12 (Julian day 132), `EIBDATE` = 1026132.
- `EIBTIME` — six-digit `HMMSS`.

If `ABSTIME(target)` is given, `target` receives a 15-digit decimal string representing milliseconds since 1900-01-01 00:00:00.000. Pass that value to `FORMATTIME` to break it back into formatted date / time components.

`ASKTIME` is the only way to get a fresh `ABSTIME`; the bricks-specific `ASSIGN DATE / TIME` shortcuts return formatted strings only.

Options `ABSTIME(target)` Variable that receives the 15-character absolute time. Optional; when omitted, only `EIBDATE` and `EIBTIME` are refreshed.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Always (clock reads cannot fail).

Example

```
EXEC CICS ASKTIME ABSTIME(NOW) END-EXEC
EXEC CICS FORMATTIME ABSTIME(NOW)
          YYYYMMDD(TODAY)
          TIME(CLOCK) TIMESEP(':')
END-EXEC
SAY 'Stamped at' TODAY CLOCK
```

FORMATTIME

Decode an ABSTIME value into formatted date and time fields.

Format

```
EXEC CICS FORMATTIME ABSTIME(source)
          [DATE(t)] [DATEFORM(fmt)] [DATESEP(c)]
          [YYYYMMDD(t)] [MMDDYYYY(t)] [DDMMYYYY(t)]
          [MMDDYY(t)] [DDMMYY(t)]
          [YYYYDDD(t)] [YYDDD(t)]
          [TIME(t)] [TIMESEP(c)]
          [YEAR(t)] [MONTHOFYEAR(t)] [DAYOFMONTH(t)]
          [DAYOFWEEK(t)] [DAYCOUNT(t)]
END-EXEC
```

Description `FORMATTIME` is the IBM-standard companion to `ASKTIME`. Given a 15-digit `ABSTIME` value (typically returned by `ASKTIME ABSTIME(...)`, but any 15-digit decimal millisecond stamp is accepted), it writes the requested representations into the named target variables.

Any combination of output options may be requested in a single call; options that are omitted cost nothing.

Options `ABSTIME(source)` (*required*) The 15-digit decimal absolute time to decode.

DATE(t) with optional **DATEFORM(fmt)** and **DATESEP(c)** Generic date target. **DATEFORM** is one of `YYYYMMDD` (default), `MMDDYYYY`, `DDMMYYYY`, `MMDDYY`, `DDMMYY`. **DATESEP(c)** inserts a one-character separator between components (e.g. '-' → `2026-05-12`); omit **DATESEP** for a packed string with no separators.

YYYYMMDD / **MMDDYYYY** / **DDMMYYYY** / **MMDDYY** / **DDMMYY** Direct date format targets; each respects **DATESEP(c)** if given.

YYYYDDD(t) / **YYDDD(t)** Julian-style date with three-digit day-of-year. Honour **DATESEP**.

TIME(t) with optional **TIMESEP(c)** Six-digit HHMMSS, or with **TIMESEP(':')** formatted as HH:MM:SS.

YEAR(t) — four-digit year (2026). **MONTHOFYEAR(t)** — 1..12. **DAYOFMONTH(t)** — 1..31. **DAYOFWEEK(t)** — 0 (Sunday) .. 6 (Saturday), per IBM CICS. **DAYCOUNT(t)** — days since 1900-01-01 (signed, integer).

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	All requested fields written.
INVREQ	16	ABSTIME is missing, not 15 decimal digits, or out of range.

Example

```
EXEC CICS ASKTIME ABSTIME(WS-NOW) END-EXEC
EXEC CICS FORMATIME ABSTIME(WS-NOW)
           DATE(WS-DATE)  DATEFORM('DDMMYYYY')  DATESEP('/')
           TIME(WS-TIME)  TIMESEP(':')
           DAYOFWEEK(WS-DOW)
END-EXEC.
*  WS-DATE → "12/05/2026"    WS-TIME → "10:30:45"    WS-DOW → "2"
```

Part 5. EXEC CICS file and queue commands

Part 5 begins here. This part covers the persistent and ephemeral data services — VSAM-style KSDS files and the temporary- storage / transient-data queue families. Both surfaces are per-task and bound by the same SYNCPOINT mechanism described in Chapter 10.

Chapter 7. KSDS file commands

VSAM in Bricks. Bricks’s KSDS file surface is the application- programmer’s view of the persistent record store. Each FILE name in EXEC CICS READ FILE(name) corresponds to a B+tree bucket in the embedded `data/files.bolt` database — there is no separate KSDS dataset definition step, no DEFINE CLUSTER. The first EXEC CICS WRITE creates the bucket; subsequent READ / REWRITE / DELETE / STARTBR / READNEXT / READPREV / RESETBR / ENDBR see it. Records are opaque byte payloads; the application chooses the layout (typically a pipe-delimited group of fields, the convention every sample uses).

These commands operate on a **single record**, identified by a key, in a CICS FILE. Each FILE is a bolt bucket inside `data/files.bolt`; record bodies are opaque bytes (the application chooses the layout). See *How file storage works* in the README for the on-disk model.

READ

Read a record from a KSDS by key.

Format

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE(name)
           {INTO(target) | SET(target)}
           RIDFLD(key)
           [UPDATE]
           [LENGTH(len)]
END-EXEC
```

Description B+tree exact-key lookup, $O(\log n)$. The record bytes (whatever the application stored) come back into the target. **UPDATE** records a per-session lock on the key, gating a subsequent **REWRITE** on the same **FILE**.

When **LENGTH(var)** is a bare variable, the actual record length is written back.

Options **FILE(name)** — *required* The CICS FILE name.

INTO(target) / SET(target) — *one required* Destination for the record body. **INTO** and **SET** are accepted interchangeably here.

RIDFLD(key) — *required* The key to look up.

UPDATE Record a per-session lock so a subsequent **REWRITE** can update this record.

LENGTH(len) Receives the record's actual length when the option is a bare variable.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Record returned.
NOTFND	13	Key not present.
INVREQ	16	Missing required option, or invalid file name.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS')
           INTO(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY)
END-EXEC
IF EIBRESP = 13 THEN MSG = 'Customer not found'
```

WRITE

Insert a new record into a KSDS.

Format

```
EXEC CICS WRITE FILE(name)
                FROM(data)
                RIDFLD(key)
END-EXEC
```

Description B+tree insert. The bucket for the FILE is created implicitly on first WRITE — there is no EXEC CICS DEFINE FILE step. DUPREC if a record with the same key already exists.

The write commits in a single bbolt **Update** transaction with **fsync** on success.

Options **FILE(name)** — *required* Target FILE. Created if absent.

FROM(data) — *required* The record bytes to store.

RIDFLD(key) — *required* The key under which to store the record.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Record written.
DUPREC	14	A record with this key already exists.
INVREQ	16	Missing required option, or invalid name.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example

```
REC = NM || '|' || AD || '|' || CY || '|' || PH
EXEC CICS WRITE FILE('CUSTOMERS') FROM(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY) END-EXEC
```

REWRITE

Replace the record locked by the most recent READ ... UPDATE.

Format

```
EXEC CICS REWRITE FILE(name)
                FROM(data)
END-EXEC
```

Description Overwrites the value at the key locked by the most recent READ FILE ... UPDATE on the same FILE. Releases the per-FCB update lock at end of transaction.

Options **FILE(name)** — *required* **FROM(data)** — *required*

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Record updated.
INVREQ	16	No prior READ ... UPDATE, or the lock has been released.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY) UPDATE END-EXEC
PARSE VAR REC NM '|' AD '|' CY '|' PH
PH = NEWPHONE                               /* mutate */
REC = NM || '|' || AD || '|' || CY || '|' || PH
EXEC CICS REWRITE FILE('CUSTOMERS') FROM(REC) END-EXEC
```

DELETE

Remove a record from a KSDS.

Format

```
EXEC CICS DELETE FILE(name)
                    [RIDFLD(key)]
END-EXEC
```

Description If RIDFLD is supplied, deletes that key. Otherwise deletes the key locked by the most recent READ ... UPDATE on the same FILE.

Options **FILE(name)** — *required*

RIDFLD(key) Optional. When omitted, the most recent READ-UPDATE key is used.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Record deleted.
NOTFND	13	Key not present.
INVREQ	16	No RIDFLD and no prior READ-UPDATE; or invalid name.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example

```
EXEC CICS DELETE FILE('CUSTOMERS') RIDFLD(CKEY) END-EXEC
```

Chapter 8. KSDS browse commands

A **browse** walks a CICS FILE in B+tree key order. The browse runs inside a bbolt MVCC read transaction, so the cursor sees a stable point-in-time snapshot — concurrent **WRITE** / **REWRITE** / **DELETE** on the same FILE do not disturb an in-progress browse.

The browse is **per-task** and tied to one FILE. A program may have multiple browses open on different FILEs at once; a second **STARTBR** on the same FILE replaces the first (**STARTBR** is implicitly idempotent in CICS).

The dispatcher releases any cursor the program forgot to **ENDBR** via a `defer handler.CloseBrowses()` at task end.

STARTBR

Open a browse cursor on a KSDS file.

Format

```
EXEC CICS STARTBR FILE(name)
                [RIDFLD(start)]
                [GTEQ | EQUAL]
                [GENERIC]
                [KEYLENGTH(n)]
END-EXEC
```

Description Opens a B+tree browse cursor on the file. With no **RIDFLD**, positions on the first key. With **RIDFLD** and **GTEQ** (the IBM default and bricks default), positions on the first key `start`. With **EQUAL**, requires an exact match (**NOTFND** if absent). With **GENERIC** and **KEYLENGTH(n)**, positions on (and walks only through) keys whose first `n` bytes match the first `n` bytes of **RIDFLD**.

Options **FILE(name)** — *required*

RIDFLD(start) Starting key. Default: first key in the file.

GTEQ | **EQUAL** Comparison rule. Default **GTEQ**.

GENERIC Restrict the walk to keys whose prefix matches.

KEYLENGTH(n) With **GENERIC**, the prefix length to match.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Cursor opened.
NOTFND	13	EQUAL requested but no such key.
INVREQ	16	Missing required option, invalid name, etc.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example

```
EXEC CICS STARTBR FILE('CUSTOMERS')
      RIDFLD('NY-')
      GENERIC KEYLENGTH(3)
END-EXEC
```

READNEXT

Step the open browse cursor forward by one record.

Format

```
EXEC CICS READNEXT FILE(name)
      {INTO(target) | SET(target)}
      [RIDFLD(keyvar)]
      [LENGTH(len)]
END-EXEC
```

Description Advances the cursor and returns the next record (or the first record if this is the first READNEXT after STARTBR). When RIDFLD is a bare variable, the matching key is written back; when LENGTH is a bare variable, the actual record length is written back.

Returns ENDFILE past the last key (or past the end of the GENERIC prefix). Records that were deleted by a concurrent transaction between STARTBR and the read are skipped automatically (bounded forward loop, no goroutine-stack risk).

Options FILE(name) — *required*

INTO(target) / SET(target) — *one required*

RIDFLD(keyvar) Receives the key of the record returned.

LENGTH(len) Receives the actual record length.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Record returned.
ENDFILE	20	Past the last key (or out of GENERIC prefix).
INVREQ	16	No STARTBR is open on this FILE.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example See STARTBR example, then:

```
DO FOREVER
  EXEC CICS READNEXT FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(K) END-EXEC
  IF EIBRESP = 20 THEN LEAVE
```

```
SAY K ':' REC  
END
```

READPREV

Step the open browse cursor backward by one record.

Format

```
EXEC CICS READPREV FILE(name)  
                {INTO(target) | SET(target)}  
                [RIDFLD(keyvar)]  
                [LENGTH(len)]  
END-EXEC
```

Description Same writeback rules as READNEXT. Returns **ENDFILE** before the first key (or before the start of the **GENERIC** prefix). Useful for paginating backward through a key range.

Options As for READNEXT.

Conditions As for READNEXT, with **ENDFILE** meaning *before the first key*.

Example

```
EXEC CICS READPREV FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(K) END-EXEC
```

RESETBR

Reposition the cursor of an open browse without closing the underlying read transaction.

Format

```
EXEC CICS RESETBR FILE(name)  
                RIDFLD(start)  
                [GTEQ | EQUAL]  
                [GENERIC]  
                [KEYLENGTH(n)]  
END-EXEC
```

Description Cheaper than **ENDBR + STARTBR** when the program wants to jump within the same browse session — the read snapshot is preserved.

Options As for **STARTBR**. **RIDFLD** is required.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Cursor repositioned.
INVREQ	16	No STARTBR is open on this FILE .
NOTFND	13	EQUAL requested but no such key.

Example

```
EXEC CICS RESETBR FILE('CUSTOMERS') RIDFLD('00500') END-EXEC
```

ENDBR

Close an open browse cursor.

Format

```
EXEC CICS ENDBR FILE(name)
END-EXEC
```

Description Releases the cursor and the underlying bbolt read transaction. The dispatcher releases any cursor the program forgot to **ENDBR** at task end, but explicit **ENDBR** is recommended.

Options **FILE(name)** — *required*

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Cursor closed.
INVREQ	16	No STARTBR is open on this FILE .

Example

```
EXEC CICS ENDBR FILE('CUSTOMERS') END-EXEC
```

Chapter 9. Temporary storage and transient data commands

Bricks supports two related queue families:

- **Temporary Storage (TS)** — ordered, persistent sequences of opaque byte items inside the bbolt database. Each queue is a sub-bucket whose keys are 8-byte big-endian item numbers (1, 2, 3 ...) and whose values are the item payloads. Item-addressed; reads and writes are $O(\log N)$. Use for ephemeral state, scratch storage, producer/consumer chaining inside the database.

- **Transient Data extra-partition (TD)** — sequential text files in a sandboxed on-disk directory (`tmp_dir`). Line-oriented; read-once-and-advance / append-only semantics. Use for staging imports from text files into VSAM and exports out of it. The REXX `LINEIN` / `LINEOUT` / `STREAM` family hits the same backend, so a file written by COBOL is readable by REXX and vice-versa.

The encoding contract for TD files is strict: ASCII bytes only (`0x09` TAB, `0x20–0x7E` printable), no EBCDIC, no UTF; lines are terminated by a single LF (`0x0A`); CR (`0x0D`) is rejected on write with `INVREQ`. The sandbox enforces a flat namespace under `tmp_dir` — no sub-directories, no leading dot, no `..`, no slashes in the queue name. See The `tmp_dir` sandbox below for the full rules.

READQ TS

Read an item from a temporary storage queue.

Format

```
EXEC CICS READQ TS QUEUE(name)
                INTO(target)
                [ITEM(n) | NEXT]
                [LENGTH(len)]
                [NUMITEMS(num)]
```

END-EXEC

`QNAME` is accepted as a synonym for `QUEUE`.

Description Reads one item from the queue. With `ITEM(n)`, returns item `n`. Without `ITEM`, or with `NEXT`, advances the **per-task implicit cursor**: the first cursor-less `READQ` on a queue returns item 1, the second returns item 2, and so on. The cursor is keyed on the running TxCB and released when the task ends — a fresh invocation of the same TRANSID starts at item 1 again.

Options `QUEUE(name)` / `QNAME(name)` — *required*

`INTO(target)` — *required*

`ITEM(n) | NEXT` Item to read. Default = next per the implicit cursor.

`LENGTH(len)` Receives the actual item length.

`NUMITEMS(num)` Receives the queue's current high-water item count.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Item returned.
ITEMERR	26	<code>ITEM(n)</code> out of range, or implicit cursor past the last item.
QIDERR	44	Queue does not exist.
INVREQ	16	Missing required option, invalid name.

Example

```
DO FOREVER
  EXEC CICS READQ TS QUEUE(QNM) INTO(REC) END-EXEC
  IF EIBRESP = 26 THEN LEAVE          /* end of queue */
  SAY REC
END
```

WRITEQ TS

Append a new item to a queue, or rewrite an existing item.

Format

```
EXEC CICS WRITEQ TS QUEUE(name)
                        FROM(data)
                        [ITEM(n) REWRITE]
END-EXEC
```

QNAME is accepted as a synonym for QUEUE.

Description In **append** mode (no **ITEM REWRITE**), the item is added at the next sequence number; an in-memory high-water-mark counter assigns the number without scanning. When **ITEM(var)** is a bare variable, the assigned item number is written back.

In **rewrite** mode (both **ITEM(n)** and **REWRITE** present), item **n** is replaced.

The write commits in a single bbolt transaction so a crash mid-write leaves either the prior state or the new one — never a partial.

Options **QUEUE(name)** / **QNAME(name)** — *required* **FROM(data)** — *required* **ITEM(n) REWRITE** Both required for rewrite mode; either alone is rejected.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Item written.
ITEMERR	26	ITEM(n) REWRITE and item n does not exist.
INVREQ	16	Missing required option, invalid name, or ITEM/REWRITE not paired.
IOERR	17	Underlying store error.

Example

```
EXEC CICS WRITEQ TS QUEUE('AUDIT') FROM(MSG) ITEM(I) END-EXEC
SAY 'Wrote item' I
```

DELETEQ TS

Delete an entire temporary storage queue.

Format

```
EXEC CICS DELETEQ TS QUEUE(name) END-EXEC
```

Description Drops the queue's sub-bucket and resets the in-memory counters and cursors. Subsequent `WRITEQ` will recreate it starting at item 1.

Options `QUEUE(name)` / `QNAME(name)` — *required*

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Queue deleted.
QIDERR	44	Queue does not exist.

Example

```
EXEC CICS DELETEQ TS QUEUE('AUDIT') END-EXEC
```

READQ TD

Read the next line from a sequential text file in `tmp_dir`.

Format

```
EXEC CICS READQ TD QUEUE(name)
        INTO(target)
        [LENGTH(len)]
END-EXEC
```

`QNAME` is accepted as a synonym for `QUEUE`. `name` is a flat filename under `tmp_dir`; sub-directories and traversal are rejected with `INVREQ`.

Description Reads the next LF-terminated line from `tmp_dir/name`, strips the terminating LF, and copies the payload into `target`. The file is auto-opened in read mode on the first call per task and the read cursor advances item-by-item across subsequent calls. A program that `WRITEs` then `READs` the same queue causes the handler to close the write handle and reopen for read; the read cursor restarts at line 1. The handle is closed automatically at task end.

Options **QUEUE(name)** / **QNAME(name)** — *required*

INTO(target) — *required*

LENGTH(len) Receives the line's byte count (after the LF strip).

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Line returned.
QZERO	12	End-of-file. target is untouched; bricks closes the handle so a later READQ on the same queue rewinds to line 1.
QIDERR	44	File does not exist in tmp_dir .
INVREQ	16	Missing INTO / invalid name / sandbox rejection.
IOERR	17	Underlying file-system error.

Example

```
PERFORM IMPORT-ONE UNTIL DONE-FLAG = 'Y'.
...
IMPORT-ONE.
    MOVE SPACES TO REC.
    EXEC CICS READQ TD QUEUE('orders.sample.txt') INTO(REC) END-EXEC.
    IF EIBRESP = 12 THEN
        MOVE 'Y' TO DONE-FLAG
    END-IF.
    IF EIBRESP = 0 THEN
        PERFORM HANDLE-RECORD
    END-IF.
```

WRITEQ TD

Append a line to a sequential text file in **tmp_dir**.

Format

```
EXEC CICS WRITEQ TD QUEUE(name)
                    FROM(data)
                    [LENGTH(len)]
END-EXEC
```

QNAME is accepted as a synonym for **QUEUE**.

Description Appends **data** plus a single LF to **tmp_dir/name**. The file is auto-opened in append mode (creating it if absent) on the first call per task. Trailing ASCII spaces on **data** are right-stripped before write — COBOL **PIC X(n)** values arrive padded to the right and the canonical text-file convention is to strip them. The payload is validated byte-by-byte: anything outside **0x09** (TAB), **0x0A** (LF), or **0x20–0x7E** (printable ASCII) causes the write to fail with **INVREQ** and a byte-offset diagnostic. CR (**0x0D**) is explicitly rejected — bricks emits Unix-style LF-only files.

Options **QUEUE(name)** / **QNAME(name)** — *required*

FROM(data) — *required*

LENGTH(len) Accepted for syntactic compatibility; the actual byte count is **LENGTH(data)** after **rstrip**.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Line appended.
INVREQ	16	Missing FROM / invalid name / sandbox rejection / non-ASCII byte / CR in payload.
IOERR	17	Underlying file-system error.

Example

```
DO I = 1 TO REC.0
  EXEC CICS WRITEQ TD QUEUE('export.txt') FROM(REC.I) END-EXEC
END
```

DELETEQ TD

Delete a sequential text file in **tmp_dir**.

Format

```
EXEC CICS DELETEQ TD QUEUE(name) END-EXEC
```

Description Closes any handle the task has open on **name**, then unlinks the file. Already-gone is treated as success (matches the **DELETE FILE** forgiving semantics in bricks). Use to reset an export staging file before a fresh batch.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	File deleted (or already absent).
INVREQ	16	Invalid name / sandbox rejection.
IOERR	17	Underlying file-system error.

Example

```
EXEC CICS DELETEQ TD QUEUE('export.txt') END-EXEC.
```

The `tmp_dir` sandbox

`tmp_dir` is configured in `bricks.cnf`:

```
tmp_dir = runtime/tmp
```

Defaults to `runtime/tmp` (under `runtime_dir`) when the line is omitted. The directory is created at startup if missing.

Name rules. A queue name must match `[A-Za-z0-9._-]{1,255}` — no leading dot, no `..`, no slash, no backslash, no NUL. Bricks also runs `filepath.Rel` against every resolved path as defense-in-depth, so symlink shenanigans bounce too.

Encoding rules. ASCII only — no EBCDIC, no UTF-8, no UTF-16. The write path validates every byte and rejects with `INVREQ` on the first violation, naming the offending offset and hex value. Lines terminate with LF only; CR is rejected on write. The read path splits on LF and preserves any CR bytes it finds verbatim — bricks does **not** silently strip them. If you need to import a file authored on Windows, pre-strip the CRs:

```
tr -d '\r' < windows.csv > runtime/tmp/clean.csv
```

Cross-language interoper. Both COBOL (`READQ TD / WRITEQ TD`) and REXX (`LINEIN / LINEOUT / STREAM`) hit the same `*cics.TmpStore` backend. A file produced by one language is readable by the other; the only constraint is that both sides agree on the column format inside each line (canonical bricks convention: pipe-delimited).

Task-end cleanup. Every handle the program opens is closed automatically when the task ends. A program that forgets to call `STREAM CLOSE` or `DELETEQ TD` does not leak descriptors.

Chapter 10. Recovery and condition handling

This chapter covers two related families:

- **Unit-of-work commands** — `SYNCPPOINT` and `SYNCPPOINT ROLLBACK` group multiple file / TS mutations into one atomic step that can be committed or undone.
- **Non-local control commands** — `HANDLE CONDITION`, `IGNORE CONDITION`, `HANDLE AID`, and `HANDLE ABEND` arm program labels that the dispatcher branches to on a non-NORMAL response, on a particular AID key, or when the task abends. Together with the per-call `EIBRESP` test (Chapter 12) and `REXX SIGNAL ON ERROR` (Chapter 18) they cover the full range of CICS error-handling idioms.

How the unit of work works

Each task owns a **journal** of pending undo entries that lives on its TxCB. Every successful **WRITE** / **REWRITE** / **DELETE** and every **WRITEQ TS** / **DELETEQ TS** appends an inverse operation to the journal *immediately after* the underlying bbolt write commits.

- **SYNCPOINT** clears the journal — the work becomes irrevocably committed, and a new unit of work begins.
- **SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK** walks the journal in reverse and applies each inverse op (re-writing pre-images, re-creating deleted records, restoring queue contents, etc.), then clears the journal.
- **RETURN** performs an **implicit SYNCPOINT** before the task ends.
- **ABEND** performs an **implicit SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK** *unless* a **HANDLE ABEND** exit catches it; the exit may then choose whether to commit or roll back explicitly.

In-flight uncommitted writes are visible to concurrent tasks (this matches IBM CICS under **READ NO UPDATE**); the rollback model exists to recover *the current task* from its own partially-applied work, not to provide multi-task isolation.

How the condition / AID / abend traps work

After every **EXEC CICS** command, the dispatcher writes **EIBRESP** and then consults three optional per-task tables:

Table	Populated by	Consulted	Branches when
Condition map	HANDLE CONDITION / IGNORE CONDITION	After every command	EIBRESP $\neq$ NORMAL and a label is armed for that condition (or for ERROR).
AID map	HANDLE AID	After every command that updates EIBAID (SEND MAP , RECEIVE MAP , RECEIVE)	The new EIBAID matches an armed key (PF1 – PF24 , PA1 – PA3 , ENTER , CLEAR , or the catch-all ANYKEY).
Abend exit	HANDLE ABEND	When the task abends	An exit is armed and not cancelled.

When a trap fires, control transfers to the named label as if the program had **GO TO**'d (COBOL) or **SIGNAL**'d (REXX) it directly. The trap *stays armed* across the branch — re-arming after each fire is not required (and the **IGNORE** / bare-name disarm forms exist for when the program wants the trap to stop firing).

SYNCPOINT

Commit the current unit of work and begin a new one.

Format

EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT END-EXEC

Description Clears the task's undo journal. All file / TS writes performed since the last **SYNCPOINT** (or since the task began) are made permanent; they can no longer be rolled back. A fresh, empty journal is started and subsequent mutations accumulate against it.

SYNCPOINT is implicit on **EXEC CICS RETURN** — programs that run to completion never need to call it explicitly. The explicit form is useful in long-running tasks that want to checkpoint partial progress, or in programs that mix recoverable phases with phases where rollback is no longer meaningful.

Options None.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Journal cleared.

SYNCPOINT cannot fail in bricks because the underlying bbolt writes have already committed by the time the journal entry was appended.

Example

```
* Phase 1: build the audit row, commit immediately so a later
* validation failure does not undo the audit trail.
EXEC CICS WRITEQ TS QUEUE('AUDIT') FROM(WS-LOG) END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT END-EXEC.

* Phase 2: real business work; rolled back if validation fails.
EXEC CICS REWRITE FILE('CUSTOMERS') FROM(WS-CUST) END-EXEC.
IF WS-INVALID
    EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK END-EXEC
    EXEC CICS ABEND ABCODE('VAL1') END-EXEC
END-IF.
```

SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK

Discard the current unit of work and begin a new one.

Format

```
EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK END-EXEC
```

Description Walks the task's undo journal in reverse and applies each inverse operation:

- **WRITE** is undone by deleting the new key.
- **REWRITE** is undone by re-writing the captured pre-image.
- **DELETE** is undone by re-writing the deleted record.
- **WRITEQ TS** (append) is undone by deleting the appended item.
- **WRITEQ TS ... REWRITE** is undone by re-writing the pre-image.

- DELETEQ TS is undone by restoring every prior item from a snapshot taken before the delete.

After the walk the journal is cleared and a new unit of work begins.

ROLLBACK is implicit when EXEC CICS ABEND runs **without** a HANDLE ABEND exit. When an exit *does* intercept the abend, the exit code decides whether to call SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK (typical) or SYNCPOINT (commit partial work and continue).

Options ROLLBACK is the only option — it is what distinguishes this form from plain SYNCPOINT.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	All journal entries successfully reverted.
ROLLEDBACK	82	One or more inverse ops failed (the underlying bbolt error is logged). The journal is still cleared; some writes may remain partially undone.

Example

ADDRESS CICS

```
EXEC CICS WRITE FILE('ACCT') RIDFLD(DEBIT_ID) FROM(DEBIT_REC) END-EXEC
EXEC CICS WRITE FILE('ACCT') RIDFLD(CREDIT_ID) FROM(CREDIT_REC) END-EXEC
```

```
IF DEBIT_TOTAL <> CREDIT_TOTAL THEN DO
  EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK END-EXEC      /* both writes undone */
  EXEC CICS ABEND ABCODE('IMBL') END-EXEC
END
```

```
EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT END-EXEC                /* commit both writes */
```

HANDLE CONDITION

Arm program labels to receive control on named EXEC CICS conditions.

Format

```
EXEC CICS HANDLE CONDITION cond1[(label)] cond2[(label)] ...
END-EXEC
```

Description Builds a per-task map from condition name to label. After every EXEC CICS command, when EIBRESP $\neq$ NORMAL, the dispatcher consults the map:

1. If the *exact* condition name is armed, control branches to the named label.
2. Otherwise, if the catch-all ERROR is armed, control branches to that label.
3. Otherwise, the response code is left in EIBRESP for the program to test, exactly as if HANDLE CONDITION had never been issued.

The (label) form arms the trap; the bare condition name (no parens) **disarms** it. Arming a previously-armed condition replaces the old label.

HANDLE CONDITION is the legacy CICS error-handling style. Modern programs that use RESP(rc) style (or REXX SIGNAL ON ERROR) do not need it; the two styles can coexist within the same program because both ultimately read EIBRESP.

Options **condN(label)** Arm condN (one of the names in Chapter 12. Response codes, e.g. NOTFND, DUPREC, MAPFAIL, INVREQ, IOERR, LENGERR, QIDERR, ITEMERR, ENDFILE, PGMIDERR, EOC) so it branches to label.

condN (*no parens*) Disarm condN.

ERROR(label) Arm a catch-all that fires for any non-NORMAL response not matched by a more specific arm.

A single HANDLE CONDITION may combine any number of arm and disarm options.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Map updated.
INVREQ	16	Unknown condition name.

Example

ADDRESS CICS

```
EXEC CICS HANDLE CONDITION NOTFND(NOREC)
                        DUPREC(DUP)
                        ERROR(OOPS)
```

END-EXEC

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY) END-EXEC
SAY 'Found:' REC
EXIT
```

```
NOREC: SAY 'No customer with key' CKEY; EXIT 4
DUP:   SAY 'Duplicate key on insert'; EXIT 8
OOPS:  SAY 'Other CICS error, RC=' EIBRESP; EXIT 12
```

IGNORE CONDITION

Suppress the `HANDLE CONDITION` trap for one or more conditions.

Format

```
EXEC CICS IGNORE CONDITION cond1 cond2 ...  
END-EXEC
```

Description Marks each named condition as *ignored*: even if `HANDLE CONDITION` previously armed it, the trap will no longer fire and the program must test `EIBRESP` itself. `IGNORE CONDITION` stays in effect until a later `HANDLE CONDITION cond(label)` re-arms the same condition.

The distinction between *unarmed* (never armed, or disarmed by the bare-name form) and *ignored* matters only when `ERROR(label)` is armed: an unarmed condition still falls through to `ERROR`, but an ignored one does not.

Options Each operand is a bare condition name — no parentheses, no label. Multiple conditions may be combined in a single call.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Map updated.
INVREQ	16	Unknown condition name.

Example

```
EXEC CICS HANDLE CONDITION ERROR(BADIO) END-EXEC.
```

```
* We *expect* NOTFND on this READ – don't trip the ERROR trap.  
EXEC CICS IGNORE CONDITION NOTFND END-EXEC.
```

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(WS-REC) RIDFLD(WS-KEY) END-EXEC.  
IF EIBRESP = 13  
    PERFORM CREATE-NEW-CUSTOMER  
END-IF.
```

HANDLE AID

Arm program labels to receive control on a particular attention key.

Format

```
EXEC CICS HANDLE AID key1[(label)] key2[(label)] ...  
END-EXEC
```


Description Builds a per-task map from AID byte to label. After any command that updates EIBAID (SEND MAP, RECEIVE MAP, RECEIVE), the dispatcher consults the map and branches if the new EIBAID matches an armed key.

The bare key name (no parens) disarms a previously-armed key. **ANYKEY** is a catch-all matched by any AID for which no specific arm exists.

Options **keyN(label) / keyN** keyN is one of ENTER, CLEAR, PA1–PA3, PF1–PF24, or **ANYKEY**. Parenthesised arms the trap; bare disarms it.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Map updated.
INVREQ	16	Unknown AID name.

Example

ADDRESS CICS

EXEC CICS HANDLE AID PF3(QUIT) PF12(QUIT) CLEAR(QUIT) END-EXEC

DO FOREVER

EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP('CUST1') INTO(SCR.) END-EXEC

... process ...

EXEC CICS SEND MAP('CUST1') FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC

END

QUIT:

EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC

HANDLE ABEND

Arm a program-level abend exit.

Format

```
EXEC CICS HANDLE ABEND { LABEL(label) | PROGRAM(name) | CANCEL | RESET }
END-EXEC
```

Description Registers an exit that runs when the task abends (either via EXEC CICS ABEND or via an unhandled runtime error). The exit *replaces* the implicit SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK that an uncaught abend would perform — it is now the exit's responsibility to call SYNCPOINT or SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK explicitly.

EIBABCODE is set to the abend code (default AAAA) before the exit receives control.

Options LABEL(label) Branch to `label` within the current program when the task abends. This is the form REXX programs almost always use.

PROGRAM(name) XCTL to the named program when the task abends. Currently accepted by the parser; the runtime treats **PROGRAM(name)** as equivalent to **LABEL(name)** (i.e. it branches inside the current program rather than transferring control).

CANCEL Disarm the current exit and restore the previous one (one level of nesting is preserved).

RESET Re-enable an exit previously suspended by **CANCEL**.

Exactly one of **LABEL**, **PROGRAM**, **CANCEL**, **RESET** must be given.

Conditions

Condition	EIBRESP	Cause
NORMAL	0	Exit registered or restored.
INVREQ	16	Conflicting / missing options, or RESET with no prior exit.

Example

```
ADDRESS CICS
```

```
EXEC CICS HANDLE ABEND LABEL(CLEANUP) END-EXEC
```

```
EXEC CICS WRITE FILE('LEDGER') RIDFLD(K) FROM(REC) END-EXEC
```

```
EXEC CICS WRITE FILE('AUDIT') RIDFLD(K) FROM(REC) END-EXEC
```

```
/* something later may ABEND */  
EXIT
```

```
CLEANUP:
```

```
    SAY 'Caught abend' EIBABCODE
```

```
    EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK END-EXEC      /* undo both writes */
```

```
    EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
```

Chapter 11. The Execute Interface Block (EIB)

The EIB is a per-task scratch area populated by the dispatcher before the program runs and by each **EXEC CICS** command on return. In bricks the EIB is exposed as a set of well-known variable names in the program's frame; both REXX and COBOL auto-inject the names that aren't already declared.

Field	Set by	Meaning
EIBAID	SEND MAP / RECEIVE MAP	Single-byte AID character of the most recent map response. Use <code>C2X(EIBAID)</code> (REXX) or compare with <code>X'F3'</code> (COBOL) to detect PF/PA/CLEAR/ENTER.
EIBCP0SN	SEND MAP / RECEIVE MAP	1-based cursor position of the most recent map response.
EIBCALEN	dispatcher (per-task entry)	Length of <code>DFHCOMMAREA</code> flowed in from the prior task or <code>LINK</code> caller. Zero when no <code>COMMAREA</code> was passed.
EIBTRMID	dispatcher	This terminal's id. Same as <code>ASSIGN TERMID(...)</code> .
EIBRESP	every EXEC CICS	The response code of the most recent command (see Chapter 12).
EIBRESP2	every EXEC CICS	The secondary response code of the most recent command (currently always 0).
RC	every EXEC CICS	Mirror of <code>EIBRESP</code> , for REXX <code>IF RC <> 0</code> style.
DFHCOMMAREA	dispatcher / LINK / RETURN	The <code>COMMAREA</code> bytes; in COBOL, auto-injected as <code>PIC X(2000)</code> if not declared.

REXX

`EIBAID` and friends are ordinary REXX variables that the handlers write through the `cics.Frame` interface. A REXX program tests them exactly like any other variable:

```
IF EIBRESP <> 0 THEN SAY 'Command failed, RC=' EIBRESP
IF C2X(EIBAID) = 'F3' THEN EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
```

`SIGNAL ON ERROR` (Chapter 18) is the alternative to per-call `IF EIBRESP <>`.

COBOL

The same names are auto-injected as `PIC` items if the program doesn't declare them (`cobol.ensureSystemItems`). Test them with ordinary `IF` clauses:

```
IF EIBRESP NOT = 0
    DISPLAY 'Command failed'
END-IF.

IF EIBAID = X'F3'
    EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
END-IF.
```

There is no COBOL equivalent of `SIGNAL ON ERROR` yet.

Chapter 12. Response codes

After every `EXEC CICS` command the handler writes `EIBRESP`, `EIBRESP2`, and `RC` into the program's frame. The full set of constants is in `cics/resp.go`; the values a typical bricks program tests for are:

Constant	Value	Meaning
<code>NORMAL</code>	0	Success.
<code>ERROR</code>	1	Generic error.
<code>EOC</code>	6	End-of-chain (second <code>RECEIVE</code> in same task).
<code>NOTFND</code>	13	Record / key not found.
<code>DUPREC</code>	14	<code>WRITE</code> collided with an existing key.
<code>DUPKEY</code>	15	Duplicate key on a non-unique index (reserved).
<code>INVREQ</code>	16	Invalid request: bad option combination, missing data store, invalid name.
<code>IOERR</code>	17	Underlying store / network IO failed.
<code>NOSPACE</code>	18	Out of storage (reserved).
<code>NOTOPEN</code>	19	File not open (reserved).
<code>ENDFILE</code>	20	Browse walked past the last key (or out of <code>GENERIC</code> prefix).
<code>LENGERR</code>	22	Length mismatch.
<code>QZERO</code>	23	Queue is empty (reserved).
<code>ITEMERR</code>	26	TS item out of range; typical at end-of-queue.
<code>PGMIDERR</code>	27	<code>LINK</code> / <code>XCTL</code> target not in <code>transactions.conf</code> , or sub-program errored, or caller is not authorised for the target.
<code>MAPFAIL</code>	36	<code>SEND MAP</code> / <code>RECEIVE MAP</code> could not find or render the named map.
<code>QIDERR</code>	44	TS queue id invalid or unknown.

Idiomatic error handling

REXX, per-call test:

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(K) END-EXEC
SELECT
  WHEN EIBRESP = 0 THEN NOP
  WHEN EIBRESP = 13 THEN MSG = 'Customer' K 'not found'
  OTHERWISE          MSG = 'I/O error, RC=' EIBRESP
END
```

REXX, signal-on:

```
SIGNAL ON ERROR NAME CICSERR
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(K) END-EXEC
...
EXIT
CICSERR:
  SAY 'CICS error at line' SIGL ', RC=' RC
  EXIT
```

COBOL:

```
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY) END-EXEC
EVALUATE EIBRESP
  WHEN 0    CONTINUE
  WHEN 13   MOVE 'Customer not found' TO MSG
  WHEN OTHER MOVE 'I/O error' TO MSG
END-EVALUATE.
```

Chapter 13. Commands not implemented

The following commands are not implemented and the parser does not recognize them at all:

Command	Use
GETMAIN, FREEMAIN	Dynamic storage. REXX has dynamic variables; COBOL has <code>WORKING-STORAGE</code> .
ENQ, DEQ	User-level resource locking. File-level locking already exists via <code>READ ... UPDATE</code> .

Recently added

- **CONVERSE** — see Chapter 4. Syntactic sugar for `SEND MAP + RECEIVE MAP`.
- **START / RETRIEVE** — see Chapter 5. Same-terminal scheduling with payload pass-through. Cross-terminal and no-`TERMID` (headless) `STARTs` are still deferred; the v1 surface rejects them with `RESP-INVREQ` and a clear message.
- **WEB *** (server-side, Phase 1) — see “`EXEC CICS WEB`” below. The client-side surface (`WEB OPEN / SEND / RECEIVE / CONVERSE / CLOSE`) and the `DOCUMENT` API land in Phase 2; `URIMAP / TLS / mTLS` in Phase 3.

Part 7. EXEC CICS WEB command reference

Part 7 begins here. Bricks ships a complete EXEC CICS WEB family — both the **inbound** (server-side, the WAPI listener) and the **outbound** (client-side, programs calling external HTTP services). The **DOCUMENT** API for assembling response bodies from many fragments is documented here too, alongside the URIMAP catalogue, inbound mTLS, the CONVERSE WEB alias, and the dedicated copybooks.

EXEC CICS WEB — server side (Phase 1)

bricks ships an inbound HTTP listener that turns each matched request into a transaction dispatch via the EXEC CICS WEB * verbs. Enable it in `bricks.cnf` with `enable_wapi=yes`. Define routes in `runtime/web_routes.conf` — the URIMAP layer; the matched TRANSID is looked up in `transactions.conf` exactly as a 3270 operator's typed dispatch would. Both files reload on mtime change, so adding a new route requires no restart.

#	method	path-pattern	transid	[groups]	[response_timeout]
	GET	/api/customer/{id}	WAPI	public	
	POST	/api/customer	WAPC	admin	
	GET	/api/orders/{id}	OAPI	users	
	DELETE	/admin/cache/{key}	CACR	admin	5s

The matching `transactions.conf` rows route TRANSID → program (REXX or COBOL) — same format used by 3270 dispatch:

```
WAPI:rexx:wapi.rexx:public,users,admin
WAPC:cobol:wapic.cob:admin
OAPI:rexx:orders.rexx:users,admin
CACR:cobol:cacheclr.cob:admin
```

A single program is therefore reachable from **both** the 3270 prompt (the operator types its TRANSID) and the HTTP endpoint (a client hits the matching URL). The transaction distinguishes the front door by which family of verbs it calls — EXEC CICS WEB * returns INVREQ on a 3270 task, and EXEC CICS SEND MAP is meaningless on a web task — but most programs naturally use one set or the other.

A {name} placeholder in the path is exposed to the transaction via `WEB READ QUERYPARM('name')`, sharing one namespace with the inbound `?name=...` query string (path captures win on conflict).

Authentication — the same `users.conf` that CSSN uses

A web client identifies itself using **HTTP Basic authentication**, and bricks verifies the credentials against the exact same `users.conf` and bcrypt hash that the CSSN sign-on transaction uses on the 3270. The credential carrier is different (an HTTP header instead of a 3270 password field); everything downstream is identical.

Layer	3270 / CSSN	WAPI / HTTP
Credential store	runtime/users.conf	runtime/users.conf (same file)
Hashing	bcrypt	bcrypt
Verification call	auth.FileStore.Authenticate(user, pass)	auth.FileStore.Authenticate(user, pass) (same call)
Credential carrier	Hidden PASSWORD field on the CSSN map, posted by SEND→RECEIVE	Authorization: Basic base64(user:pass) header
Operator-visible state	sess.Authenticated=true; UCB attached for the whole 3270 session until CSSF LOGOFF	One-shot per request — sess.Authenticated=true for the dispatch only
What the transaction sees	EXEC CICS ASSIGN USERID(...) returns the operator	Same — EXEC CICS ASSIGN USERID(...) returns the bcrypt-verified user

The dispatch flow per request:

1. **No Authorization header** — if the route's groups column contains the literal token public, the request is accepted as anonymous (UserID="", Authenticated=false); otherwise the response is **401 Unauthorized** with WWW-Authenticate: Basic realm="bricks" so a browser shows the standard credential prompt.
2. **Authorization: Basic base64(user:pass)** — the credential is base64-decoded, split on :, then auth.FileStore.Authenticate runs (same path CSSN uses). On success the user's users.conf groups are intersected with the route's groups.
3. **Authenticated AND a group matches** — dispatch proceeds with sess.Authenticated=true, sess.UserID=<username>, sess.Groups=<users.conf groups>. The dispatcher's IsAllowed gate runs again against the TRANSID's transactions.conf groups, so **both** layers must permit the caller before the program runs.
4. **Authenticated but no group match** — **403 Forbidden**.
5. **Authentication fails** (wrong password, unknown user, malformed header) — **401 Unauthorized**.

ACL policy is **opt-in**: a web_routes.conf row with no groups column denies every request, log warning at boot. Add the literal public to permit anonymous access; add specific group names (users, admin, etc.) to require Basic-Auth against users.conf for a user belonging to that group.

A user alice listed in users.conf as alice:<bcrypt-hash>:users,admin can run the **same** TRANSID from both front doors with the same credential:

```
curl -u alice:alice-password http://localhost:8080/api/orders/42
# → 200 + JSON body, sess.UserID=alice
```

```
curl -u alice:wrong-password http://localhost:8080/api/orders/42
# → 401 Unauthorized
```

```
curl http://localhost:8080/api/orders/42
# → 401 Unauthorized (no Authorization header)
```

...and at a 3270 emulator she signs on with CSSN → alice / alice-password and types the same

TRANSID. The program sees the same EIBTRMID / USERID / EIBCALEN set and serves both callers identically. Most programs don't even need to know which front door they came from.

What's intentionally NOT yet supported:

- **Bearer tokens / cookies / sessions** — every request is stateless and re-authenticates against `users.conf`. There is no equivalent of the 3270 “stay signed on until CSSF LOGOFF” state across HTTP requests. The token-mint endpoint and `Authorization: Bearer ...` flow land in Phase 3.
- **OAuth / JWT / OIDC** — Phase 3+ work.
- **Per-request authentication via the CSSN transaction itself** — CSSN is a 3270-only screen artefact; pointing a route at it doesn't produce the browser UX a credential prompt should have. The Phase 3 token endpoint will be the right shape for that.

Server-side verb set

The Phase 1 verb set:

Verb	Use
WEB EXTRACT METHOD(var) PATH(var) ...	Request metadata: METHOD / SCHEME / HOST / PORT / PATH / QUERYSTRING / HTTPVERSION / CLIENTADDR / SERVERADDR. Each option is the name of a target variable.
WEB READ HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(var) [LENGTH(var)]	Read one inbound header. NOTFND when absent.
WEB STARTBROWSE HTTPHEADER / WEB READNEXT HTTPHEADER NAME(var) VALUE(var) [NAMELENGTH(var)] [VALUELENGTH(var)] / WEB ENDBROWSE HTTPHEADER	Walk every inbound header in sorted order. ENDFILE when exhausted.
WEB READ QUERYPARAM(name) VALUE(var)	Read query parameter OR routing-table {name} capture. NOTFND when absent.
WEB STARTBROWSE QUERYPARAM / WEB READNEXT QUERYPARAM ... / WEB ENDBROWSE QUERYPARAM	Iterate every parameter / capture.
WEB READ FORMFIELD(name) VALUE(var)	Read one application/x-www-form-urlencoded field. Body parsed lazily on first call.
WEB STARTBROWSE FORMFIELD / WEB READNEXT FORMFIELD ... / WEB ENDBROWSE FORMFIELD	Iterate form fields.
WEB RECEIVE INTO(var) [MAXLENGTH(n)] [LENGTH(var)] [TYPE(var)] [MEDIATYPE(var)]	Read the raw request body. LENGERR when over MAXLENGTH.
WEB WRITE HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(value)	Set / append an outbound response header.
WEB SEND FROM(buf) [MEDIATYPE(s)] [STATUSCODE(n)]	Emit response status + body. First SEND wins for status/MEDIATYPE; subsequent SEND calls in the same task append to the body (matches CICS).
WEB PARSE URL URL(s) SCHEMENAME(var) HOST(var) PORT(var) PATH(var) QUERYSTRING(var) [HOSTLENGTH(var)] ...	Direction-agnostic URL splitter.

Verb	Use
WEB CONVERTTIME DATESTRING(s) ABSTIME(var)	RFC 1123 / 850 / asctime → milliseconds since 1970-01-01 UTC.

The full REXX sample is `runtime/rexx/wapi.rexx`; in COBOL the helpful copybooks are `DFHWBSC` (status-code constants), `DFHWBUH` (common header-name literals), `DFHWBMT` (MIME-type literals), and `DFHWBMETH` (HTTP method literals).

EXEC CICS WEB — client side (Phase 2a)

The same `WEB` verb family also drives **outbound** HTTP — a bricks transaction calling a remote HTTP service. No `bricks.cnf` toggle is required; bricks builds one shared `*http.Client` at startup (tuned by `web_client_timeout` / `web_client_max_idle_conns` / `web_client_tls_skip_verify`) and every task reuses it. The host's CA bundle validates outbound HTTPS certificates by default — point at any normal public HTTPS endpoint and it just works.

The client uses a per-task **session token**: `WEB OPEN` returns a 32-character hex token; subsequent `WEB SEND` / `WEB RECEIVE` / `WEB CONVERSE` / `WEB CLOSE` all thread that token via `SESSTOKEN(...)`. A token still open at task end is auto-closed (dispatcher defer, mirrors `CloseBrowsers` / `CloseAllTD`).

The Phase 2a verb set:

Verb	Use
WEB OPEN HOST(s) [PORT(n)] [SCHEME(s)] SESSTOKEN(var)	Open a logical client session. PORT defaults to 80 (HTTP) / 443 (HTTPS). SCHEME defaults to http. The token is written into the variable named by SESSTOKEN.
WEB CONVERSE SESSTOKEN(t) METHOD(s) PATH(s) [FROM(buf)] [LENGTH(n)] [QUERYSTRING(s)] [MEDIATYPE(s)] INTO(var) [STATUSCODE(var)] [STATUSTEXT(var)] [MEDIATYPE(var)] [TYPE(var)] [MAXLENGTH(n)] [LENGTH(var)]	One-shot send + receive. Builds the request, fires it through the shared client, writes the response body into INTO; LENGERR when the body exceeds MAXLENGTH (default 1 MiB).
WEB SEND SESSTOKEN(t) METHOD(s) PATH(s) [FROM(buf)] [QUERYSTRING(s)] [MEDIATYPE(s)]	Stage a request on the session (no round-trip yet).
WEB RECEIVE SESSTOKEN(t) INTO(var) [STATUSCODE(var)] [STATUSTEXT(var)] [MEDIATYPE(var)] [MAXLENGTH(n)]	Fire the staged request; populate the named output variables from the response.
WEB CLOSE SESSTOKEN(t)	Release the session and the underlying response body.
WEB WRITE HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(v) SESSTOKEN(t)	Set an outbound <i>request</i> header on the session. Repeated WRITE calls for the same name produce multi-valued headers (matches <code>http.Header.Add</code>). Must precede the next SEND / CONVERSE – headers committed at request build time.

Verb	Use
WEB READ HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(var) [LENGTH(var)] SESSTOKEN(t)	Read one response header by name from the most-recent SEND/CONVERSE/RECEIVE on the session. Case-insensitive name match. NOTFND when absent; INVREQ when no response has landed yet.
WEB STARTBROWSE HTTPHEADER SESSTOKEN(t) / WEB READNEXT HTTPHEADER NAME(var) VALUE(var) [NAMELENGTH(var)] [VALUELENGTH(var)] SESSTOKEN(t) / WEB ENDBROWSE HTTPHEADER SESSTOKEN(t)	Iterate every response header in sorted order. ENDFILE when exhausted; INVREQ when no STARTBROWSE has run on the session.
WEB EXTRACT SESSTOKEN(t) [SCHEME(var)] [HOST(var)] [PORT(var)] [PATH(var)] [HOSTLENGTH(var)] [PORTNUMBER(var)]	Inspect the session's resolved endpoint <i>after</i> OPEN. Distinct from WEB EXTRACT URIMAP(name) (no token) and from the server-side request-meta form (no token, different option set).

Bricks issues **Accept: */*** and **User-Agent: bricks-cics/1.0** on every outbound request by default; both can be overridden with **WEB WRITE HTTPHEADER('User-Agent') VALUE(...) SESSTOKEN(t)** before the next SEND / CONVERSE on that session. The runtime/cobol/whdr.cob sample (TRANSID WHDR) walks through the WRITE-then-READ flow end-to-end.

RESP codes: **NORMAL**, **NOTFND** (unknown SESSTOKEN), **INVREQ** (missing required option, web client not configured), **IOERR** (network / TLS / timeout), **LENGERR** (body over MAXLENGTH).

COBOL copybook for the client surface

runtime/cobolcopy/DFHWBSI.cpy carries the standard session-token + body buffer templates:

```
01 DFH-WB-SESS      PIC X(36).
01 DFH-WB-BODY      PIC X(8192).
01 DFH-WB-URL       PIC X(2048).
```

Pair it with the existing **DFHWBSC** (status codes) and **DFHWBMETH** (HTTP method literals) so a CICS-style program reads idiomatically:

```
COPY DFHRESP.
COPY DFHWBSC.
COPY DFHWBMETH.
COPY DFHWBSI.

EXEC CICS WEB OPEN HOST('api.github.com') PORT(443)
              SCHEME('HTTPS')
              SESSTOKEN(DFH-WB-SESS) END-EXEC.

EXEC CICS WEB CONVERSE SESSTOKEN(DFH-WB-SESS)
              METHOD(WB-GET)
              PATH('/zen')
              INTO(DFH-WB-BODY)
```

STATUSCODE(STAT) END-EXEC.

EXEC CICS WEB CLOSE SESSTOKEN(DFH-WB-SESS) END-EXEC.

IF STAT = DFHRESP-WB-OK ...

URIMAP — symbolic outbound endpoints (Phase 3a)

A URIMAP entry in `runtime/web_routes.conf` defines a named upstream service that outbound transactions reference by symbol. Both layers of `web_routes.conf` (routes for inbound, URIMAPs for outbound) live in the same file and hot-reload together.

```
# Format: URIMAP NAME scheme://host[:port][/path-prefix]
URIMAP  GITHUB    https://api.github.com
URIMAP  WEATHER   https://api.openweathermap.org/data/2.5
URIMAP  INTRANET  https://api.internal:8443/v1
```

Names are 1..8 uppercase characters (CICS resource-name limit). The path-prefix is optional; when set, it becomes the leading segment of every PATH the program later supplies on `WEB SEND` / `WEB CONVERSE`. So `URIMAP WEATHER ...data/2.5` paired with `WEB CONVERSE PATH('/weather?city=NYC')` issues against `https://api.openweathermap.org/data/2.5/weather?city=NYC`.

The URIMAP-aware verb shapes:

Verb	Use
<code>WEB OPEN URIMAP(name) SESSTOKEN(var)</code>	Open a client session against the named endpoint. SCHEME / HOST / PORT come from the URIMAP row; explicit <code>HOST(...)</code> / <code>PORT(...)</code> / <code>SCHEME(...)</code> on the same command override per-field (matches IBM CICS). <code>NOTFND</code> when the name is unknown.
<code>WEB SEND URIMAP(name) METHOD(s) PATH(s)</code> <code>[FROM(buf)] [QUERYSTRING(s)] [MEDIATYPE(s)]</code> <code>INTO(var) [STATUSCODE(var)]</code> <code>[STATUSTEXT(var)] [LENGTH(var)]</code> <code>[MAXLENGTH(n)]</code>	One-shot <code>OPEN</code> + <code>CONVERSE</code> + <code>CLOSE</code> : no <code>SESSTOKEN</code> required. Resolves the URIMAP, opens a fresh session, sends the request, populates <code>INTO</code> and the named output variables from the response, and releases the session. Use for fire-and-forget outbound calls where session-token plumbing has no value. (Phase 3b.)
<code>WEB EXTRACT URIMAP(name) [SCHEME(var)]</code> <code>[HOST(var)] [PORT(var)] [PATH(var)]</code> <code>[HOSTLENGTH(var)] [PORTNUMBER(var)]</code>	Inspect a URIMAP definition without opening a session. Used by programs that branch on the resolved endpoint or need to display it to an operator. <code>NOTFND</code> when the name is unknown.

URIMAP rows load even when `enable_wapi=no` — outbound-only deployments are supported without exposing any inbound listener.

The `runtime/cobolcopy/DFHWBUM.cpy` copybook ships the conventional `WORKING-STORAGE` variables:

```

01 DFH-WB-UM-NAME      PIC X(8).
01 DFH-WB-UM-SCHEME    PIC X(8).
01 DFH-WB-UM-HOST      PIC X(64).
01 DFH-WB-UM-PORT      PIC X(5).
01 DFH-WB-UM-PATH      PIC X(128).

```

Outbound TLS verification (Phase 3a)

By default the outbound HTTPS client verifies upstream certificates against the host system’s trust store — the OS’s `/etc/ssl/certs/...` bundle on Linux, the Keychain on macOS, Windows trust store on Windows. Three `bricks.cnf` knobs adjust:

Knob	Use
<code>web_client_ca_bundle</code>	Path to a PEM file of trusted CAs. When set, bricks uses ONLY these for verification — the system trust store is ignored. Useful for internal CAs that aren’t installed system-wide.
<code>web_client_cert</code> + <code>web_client_key</code>	PEM client-cert and key for outbound mTLS. Presented to upstream services that require the caller to authenticate with a certificate. Both must be set together; one without the other is a startup error.
<code>web_client_tls_skip_verify</code>	yes accepts ANY upstream certificate — test-only escape hatch for self-signed endpoints. Logs a loud startup WARNING ; never use in production.

Operator visibility (Phase 3a)

- **CEMT INQUIRE URIMAP** — pages the URIMAP rows loaded from `web_routes.conf` (NAME / SCHEME / HOST / PORT / PATH-PREFIX).
- **CEMT INQUIRE WEB** — pages the inbound HTTP requests currently in dispatch (METHOD / URI / TERM / TRANSID / USER / AGE). When no requests are in flight, the screen still shows a one-row summary with the lifetime request / error totals.

Phase 2a sample — `wzen.cob`

`runtime/cobol/wzen.cob` (TRANSID `WZEN`) is the shipped end-to-end demonstration. It fetches GitHub’s `/zen` endpoint over HTTPS — a single-line plain-text response, no JSON parsing needed — and renders the result on the `WZEN1` 3270 map. The program demonstrates the full client lifecycle, branches cleanly on each `EIBRESP`, and surfaces network / HTTP failures with a distinct error path so the operator sees what went wrong on the 3270 screen rather than getting an opaque abend.

Drive it from a 3270 emulator: sign on (`CSSN` → `admin`), type `WZEN`, press ENTER. The first line under the header shows the actual URL fetched (`GET https://api.github.com/zen`) so the demo is self-documenting; the body appears on row 8.

Phase 2b sample — whdr.cob (custom request + response headers)

runtime/cobol/whdr.cob (TRANSID WHDR) is the canonical end-to-end demonstration of `WEB WRITE HTTPHEADER` and `WEB READ HTTPHEADER` on a client session. It opens the `GITHUB URIMAP`, sets two outbound headers (`User-Agent: bricks-whdr/1.0`, `Accept: text/plain`), issues `GET /zen`, then reads three response headers — two that always land on a GitHub response (`Content-Type`, `Server`) and one deliberately-absent header to exercise the `NOTFND` branch. The 3270 screen shows the request headers sent, the response headers received, and the body excerpt.

Drive it the same way as `WZEN`: sign on with `CSSN`, type `WHDR`, press `ENTER`. Pair the screen with `CEMT INQUIRE WEB` in a second 3270 session to watch the per-route counters move each time you rerun the transaction.

EXEC CICS DOCUMENT — chunked body builder

The `DOCUMENT` API is the buffer-builder that pairs with `WEB SEND DOCTOKEN(t)` for programs assembling large responses from many small fragments. Classic CICS pattern for emitting `HTML` / `XML` / `JSON` in pieces; the bricks implementation also serves as the chunk store for `WEB RETRIEVE DOCTOKEN(var)` when programs want the inbound body as a document handle instead of a flat `INTO(buf)`.

Verb	Use
<code>DOCUMENT CREATE DOCTOKEN(var)</code> <code>[SYMBOLLIST(s)] [LISTLENGTH(n)]</code> <code>[DELIMITER(s)]</code>	Allocate a fresh empty document; return its token in the named variable. Optional <code>SYMBOLLIST</code> seeds a <code>name=value&...</code> symbol table that subsequent <code>INSERT SYMBOL(...)</code> substitutes from.
<code>DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(t) [FROM(buf)</code> <code>[LENGTH(n)] \ TEXT(buf) \ BINARY(buf) \ </code> <code>SYMBOL(name) \ DOCUMENT(other-token)]</code> <code>[AT(position)]</code>	Append (or splice with <code>AT(position)</code>) one chunk to the document. <code>SYMBOL(name)</code> substitutes from the bound symbol list (<code>NOTFND</code> when unknown); <code>DOCUMENT(other-token)</code> splices another document verbatim (<code>NOTFND</code> when unknown); <code>TEXT</code> and <code>BINARY</code> are codepage-aware in real CICS but collapse to <code>FROM</code> in bricks (single-codepage). <code>LENGERR</code> when the resulting buffer would exceed 4 MiB.
<code>DOCUMENT SET DOCTOKEN(t) SYMBOLLIST(s)</code> <code>[LISTLENGTH(n)] [DELIMITER(d)] [UNESCAPED]</code>	(Re-)bind the symbol list a subsequent <code>INSERT SYMBOL</code> substitutes from. Pass an empty <code>SYMBOLLIST</code> to clear.
<code>DOCUMENT RETRIEVE DOCTOKEN(t) INTO(buf)</code> <code>LENGTH(var) [CHARACTERSET(s)] [DATAONLY \ </code> <code>HOSTCODEPAGE]</code>	Read the assembled body back into <code>INTO</code> ; <code>LENGTH</code> receives the byte count. <code>CHARACTERSET</code> / <code>DATAONLY</code> / <code>HOSTCODEPAGE</code> are accepted but ignored (bricks is single-codepage ASCII).
<code>DOCUMENT DELETE DOCTOKEN(t)</code>	Release the document. <code>NOTFND</code> when the token isn't known. Forgotten documents are released at task end automatically.

Verb	Use
WEB SEND DOCTOKEN(t) [STATUSCODE(n)] [MEDIATYPE(s)]	Emit the named document as the outbound response body. The DOCUMENT INSERT chain has already built it; SEND just splices the bytes onto BodyOut. NOTFND when the token isn't known.
WEB RETRIEVE DOCTOKEN(var)	Inbound-body-as-document. Allocates a fresh document, copies the request body into it, and returns the token. Alternative to WEB RECEIVE INTO(buf) for programs that prefer the document API.

The standard COBOL declaration:

```

COPY DFHDCDOC.    *> DFH-DOC-TOK (PIC X(36)) + delimiter constants

EXEC CICS DOCUMENT CREATE DOCTOKEN(DFH-DOC-TOK) END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(DFH-DOC-TOK)
                        FROM('<html><body>') END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(DFH-DOC-TOK)
                        FROM(BODY-CHUNK) END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(DFH-DOC-TOK)
                        FROM('</body></html>') END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS WEB SEND DOCTOKEN(DFH-DOC-TOK)
                        MEDIATYPE('text/html')
                        STATUSCODE(200) END-EXEC.

```

RESP codes: **NORMAL**, **NOTFND** (unknown DOCTOKEN, unknown SYMBOL, unknown spliced DOCUMENT), **INVREQ** (missing required option), **LENGERR** (INSERT would exceed 4 MiB), **IOERR** (token generation failed).

EXEC CICS WEB — Phase 3b additions

Phase 3b closes out the master Phase-3 surface. Each addition slots onto the foundations laid by 3a (URIMAP catalogue, active- request tracking, outbound TLS extras) without breaking existing verb shapes.

CONVERSE WEB — alias for WEB CONVERSE

Some shops write the keywords in either order; bricks normalises both at the parser, so the two forms below dispatch identical:

```

EXEC CICS WEB CONVERSE SESSTOKEN(T) METHOD('GET')
                        PATH('/x') INTO(B) END-EXEC.
EXEC CICS CONVERSE WEB SESSTOKEN(T) METHOD('GET')
                        PATH('/x') INTO(B) END-EXEC.

```

WEB EXTRACT TCPIPSERVICE — inspect the receiving listener

When **WEB EXTRACT** carries the **TCPIPSERVICE** keyword (or the legacy **EXTRACT TCPIP** form without **WEB**), the verb reports the listener that received the inbound request:

Output	Source
TCPIPSERVICE(var)	Symbolic listener name — WAPI for the plain port, WAPITLS for the TLS port.
PORTNUMBER(var)	Numeric port the listener is bound to.
IPADDRESS(var)	The server's bind address (mirrors bricks.cnf::dns_name).
CLIENT(var)	Caller's IP address (mirrors WEB EXTRACT CLIENTADDR).
AUTHENTICATE(var)	BASIC when the request carried Authorization: Basic ... , blank otherwise.

The legacy form drops the **WEB** keyword entirely — the parser recognises **EXTRACT TCPIP CLIENT(...)** **AUTHENTICATE(...)** and routes it through the same handler. Useful for programs ported from pre-CICS-TS web-services code.

Inbound mTLS + WEB EXTRACT CERTIFICATE

Set **web_inbound_client_ca=ca.pem** to require every TLS client to present a certificate signed by **ca.pem**. The TLS handshake rejects unauthorised clients before any verb runs — no transaction is dispatched at all. Inside the dispatched program, **WEB EXTRACT CERTIFICATE** reads the verified peer cert:

Output	Source on the peer cert
COMMONNAME(var)	Subject CN.
ORGANISATION(var)	Subject O.
COUNTRY(var)	Subject C.
SERIALNUM(var)	Hex serial number.
ISSUER(var)	Issuer CN.
ISSUERORG(var)	Issuer O.

EIBRESP = NOTFND on plain (non-TLS) requests and on TLS requests that carried no client cert — so one **TRANSID** can serve both authenticated and anonymous callers and branch on the resp.

```
COPY DFHRESP.
COPY DFHWBCC.  *> CN / ORG / CO / SERIAL / ISSUER buffers
EXEC CICS WEB EXTRACT CERTIFICATE
      COMMONNAME(DFH-WB-CN)
      ORGANISATION(DFH-WB-ORG)
      COUNTRY(DFH-WB-CO)
      SERIALNUM(DFH-WB-SERIAL)
      ISSUER(DFH-WB-ISSUER)
END-EXEC.
```

```

EVALUATE EIBRESP
  WHEN DFHRESP(NORMAL)
    *> Verified cert -- use the fields.
  WHEN DFHRESP(NOTFND)
    *> Plain HTTP or TLS without a client cert.
END-EVALUATE.

```

HTTP/2 on the inbound TLS listener

Go's `net/http` server auto-negotiates HTTP/2 over the TLS listener via ALPN whenever `tls.Config.NextProtos` is left unset — which bricks does on the WAPI TLS port. No knob is required; clients that advertise h2 in their ALPN list get HTTP/2, clients that don't fall back to HTTP/1.1. Verify with `curl --http2 -v https://localhost:443/...` and look for ALPN, server accepted to use h2 in the trace output. Cleartext HTTP/2 (h2c) is not enabled — the plain port stays on HTTP/1.1 to avoid a transitive dependency on golang.org/x/net/http2/h2c.

CEDA URIMAP — live edit the URIMAP catalogue

The Phase 3a CEMT INQUIRE URIMAP browser becomes operator-editable in 3b. Type CEDA URIMAP (or CEDA M) from the 3270 prompt for the list view:

S	NAME	SCHEME	HOST	PORT	PATH
_	GITHUB	https	api.github.com	443	-
_	WEATHER	https	api.openweathermap.org	443	/data/2.5
_	INTRANET	https	api.internal	8443	/v1

- Type **A** in the selector column for **Alter** — opens a form pre-loaded with the row's endpoint URL so a one-character edit is enough to repoint the URIMAP.
- Type **D** in the selector column for **Delete** — a Y/N confirmation overlay opens; the row is removed only when the operator types Y.
- Press **PF6** for **Define new** — opens an empty form for the NAME (1..8 chars) and END-POINT URL (`scheme://host[:port]/path-prefix`).

Every committed change is written atomically through a temp + rename to `web_routes.conf`, with an mtime guard that refuses the write if the file was modified externally between when the screen loaded and when the operator pressed PF5. Each successful mutation logs an audit line in the bricks log:

```
ceda=URIMAP op=DEFINE user=ADMIN term=T0001 target=NEWAPI detail=https://internal.svc:8443/v2
```

so the audit trail of who changed which row when is greppable.

The new in-process surface that backs the screen lives on `*web.Table`: `AddURIMap`, `AlterURIMap`, `DeleteURIMap`, and `Mtime()` for the optimistic-concurrency guard. Programs in REXX or COBOL **do not call these directly** — they're the CEDA implementation, not part of the EXEC CICS surface.

Part 3. The REXX language

Part 3 begins here. This part describes the REXX dialect bricks accepts and the small preprocessor that rewrites EXEC CICS blocks into the same parsed command shape COBOL produces. Every command in **Part 4** (EXEC CICS), **Part 6** (EXEC SQL) and **Part 7** (EXEC CICS WEB) is available verbatim from REXX with identical semantics.

Chapter 14. REXX program structure

A bricks REXX program is a flat sequence of statements with optional labels and procedures. Execution begins at the first statement; the program ends when execution falls off the bottom, or hits EXIT.

```
/* HEL0 – minimum REXX program */
ADDRESS CICS
EXEC CICS SEND MAP('HEL01') ERASE END-EXEC
EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
```

Procedures

A label followed by PROCEDURE [EXPOSE list] defines a procedure with its own variable scope. EXPOSE re-routes named variables to the caller's frame recursively.

```
CALL GREET 'Alice'
EXIT
```

```
GREET: PROCEDURE EXPOSE LANG.
  PARSE ARG NAME
  SAY LANG.HELLO NAME
  RETURN
```

ADDRESS

ADDRESS <env> switches the active command handler. Bare strings inside an ADDRESS scope are commands routed to that handler; bricks ships a CICS handler.

```
ADDRESS CICS
"SEND MAP('CUST1') FROM(SCR.) ERASE"
"RETURN"
```

Chapter 15. Variables and stems

- **Simple variables** are case-insensitive. An unset variable resolves to its uppercased name (REXX NOVALUE convention).
- **Stems** have a default value plus per-tail values:

```
STEM. = 'unset'
STEM.42 = 'forty-two'
```

```
SAY STEM.1    /* unset      */
SAY STEM.42   /* forty-two  */
```

- **Compound-variable tail substitution.** Non-numeric tail symbols are resolved at every reference. With `J = 3`, the symbol `A.J` reads or writes `A.3`. Pure numeric tails (`A.0`, `A.42`) and unset tail symbols (REXX NOVALUE) remain literal. Multi-segment tails work too: with `I=1`, `J=2`, `A.I.J` references `A.1.2`.
- **DROP name [name...]** removes one or more variables. A trailing `.` drops the entire stem (default + every tail) — useful for resetting an accumulator between paginated reads: `DROP RECS..`

See Appendix B for the canonical compound-symbol pitfall.

Chapter 16. Control flow

Construct	Forms
IF expr THEN [ELSE] SELECT ... WHEN ... OTHERWISE ... END DO, DO N, DO var=a TO b BY s, DO WHILE, DO UNTIL, DO FOREVER DO var OVER stem.	one-line or block OTHERWISE NOP works for the empty branch the usual loop family iterate over each tail of a stem; numeric tails sort first, then lexicographic
LEAVE [ctrlvar] ITERATE [ctrlvar]	exit the innermost (or named outer) DO skip to the next iteration of the innermost (or named outer) DO
CALL, RETURN, EXIT SIGNAL <label> INTERPRET expr	procedure call, return, exit non-local jump evaluate the string value of expr as REXX source and execute
NUMERIC DIGITS n / FUZZ n / FORM SCIENTIFIC ENGINEERING NOP	basic settings honoured; arithmetic is float64 internally a real no-op statement

Chapter 17. PARSE templates

`PARSE [UPPER] {VAR var | VALUE ... WITH | ARG | PULL} template`

Template features supported:

- String anchors ('literal').
- Absolute column markers (n).
- Relative column markers (+n / -n).
- The `.` placeholder (skip a token).
- Bare variable runs.

```

PARSE VAR LINE  TID  CKEY  .                /* whitespace tokens */
PARSE VAR REC   NM '|' AD '|' CY '|' PH      /* '|' delimiter      */
PARSE VAR ROW   1 NAME 21 ADDR 51 PHONE      /* fixed columns      */

```

Chapter 18. Conditions and SIGNAL ON

SIGNAL ON {ERROR | NOVALUE | SYNTAX | HALT} [NAME label] arms a condition. When it fires:

- SIGL is set to the source line of the failing statement.
- Control jumps to the labelled handler.

SIGNAL OFF cond disarms.

Condition	Fires on
ERROR	An EXEC CICS command returns a non-zero RC.
NOVALUE	A reference to an unset simple or compound variable.
SYNTAX	Any other interpreter error — bad numeric, divide by zero, unknown function, etc.
HALT	An external halt request.

Example

```

SIGNAL ON ERROR  NAME CICSERR
SIGNAL ON SYNTAX NAME OOPS

ADDRESS CICS
EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY) END-EXEC
EXIT

CICSERR:
  SAY 'EXEC CICS failed at line' SIGL ', RC=' RC
  EXIT 12

OOPS:
  SAY 'Interpreter error at line' SIGL
  EXIT 16

```

Without an armed trap, the legacy “test EIBRESP after every verb” pattern still works. For per-condition (rather than blanket) traps, use EXEC CICS HANDLE CONDITION (Chapter 10); the two styles can coexist.

Chapter 19. Built-in functions

Family	Functions
Length / index	LENGTH, POS, LASTPOS, WORDS, WORDPOS, WORDINDEX, WORDLENGTH, COUNTSTR
Substring	SUBSTR, LEFT, RIGHT, SUBWORD, WORD, DELSTR, DELWORD, INSERT, OVERLAY, CHANGESTR
Whitespace / case	STRIP, SPACE, CENTER (alias CENTRE), JUSTIFY, UPPER, LOWER, REVERSE, COPIES, ABBREV
Translation	TRANSLATE, VERIFY, COMPARE, XRANGE, BITAND, BITOR, BITXOR
Conversion	C2X, X2C, D2X, X2D, D2C, C2D, B2X, X2B
Numeric	ABS, MAX, MIN, INT, TRUNC, MOD (= // operator), SIGN, FORMAT(num, before, after), DIGITS, FUZZ, FORM
Type / data	DATATYPE (with N, W, A options), LENGTH
Date / time	DATE (N/S/E/U/O/B; B does basedate arithmetic), TIME
Stream I/O	LINEIN, LINEOUT, LINES, CHARIN, CHAROUT, CHARS, STREAM
Variables / args	VALUE, ARG, RANDOM, ERRORTXT

VALUE accepts the canonical 1-arg read form (VALUE('SCR.ROW' || J)) and the 2-arg assignment form (CALL VALUE 'SCR.ROW' || J, LINE — sets the variable named at runtime and returns the prior value).

C2X is the standard way to compare EIBAID to a PF-key code: IF C2X(EIBAID) = 'F7' THEN ... for PF7.

DATE('B') and DATE('B', 'YYYYMMDD', 'S') give days since 0001-01-01 — subtract two basedates for an exact day delta.

Stream I/O

The stream functions read and write text files in the `tmp_dir` sandbox — the same backend that powers COBOL's EXEC CICS READQ TD / WRITEQ TD / DELETEQ TD (see Chapter 9). The sandbox is strict: ASCII only, LF-terminated, no traversal.

Function	Form	Behaviour
LINEIN(name)	next line	Auto-opens <code>name</code> for read on first call; returns the next line (LF stripped). Empty string at EOF.
LINEIN(name, 1)	rewind	Closes and reopens <code>name</code> , then returns line 1. Only 1 is honoured; any other line number is treated as the “next line” form.

Function	Form	Behaviour
LINEOUT(name)	close	Closes the named stream. Returns 0.
LINEOUT(name, line)	append	Auto-opens name for append on first call; appends line '\n'. Returns 0 on success, 1 on error.
LINES(name)	EOF probe	Returns 1 while more data is available, 0 at EOF.
CHARIN(name, start, n)	byte read	Reads n bytes (default 1). start = 1 rewinds first; other start values are ignored.
CHAROUT(name, s)	byte write	Appends raw bytes. Same ASCII/LF validation as LINEOUT.
CHARS(name)	bytes remaining	Returns the file size minus the current read position.
STREAM(name, 'S')	state	Returns 'READY', 'NOTREADY', or 'ERROR'.
STREAM(name, 'D')	description	Returns a short status string ('OK' / parse-time reason).
STREAM(name, 'C', cmd)	command	OPEN READ / OPEN WRITE / OPEN APPEND / CLOSE / QUERY EXISTS / QUERY SIZE / DELETE.

```

/* Append a row, then read every row back. */
CALL LINEOUT 'export.txt', 'C0000099|WIDGET-Z|7|9.95'
CALL LINEOUT 'export.txt' /* close the writer */
DO WHILE LINES('export.txt') > 0
    SAY LINEIN('export.txt')
END
CALL STREAM 'export.txt', 'C', 'CLOSE'

```

Every handle a program opens is closed automatically at task end; an interpreter that forgets to call CLOSE does not leak descriptors. A sandbox violation ('../etc/passwd', 'sub/x', leading-dot) causes the next LINEIN / LINEOUT to raise an error and STREAM('S') to report 'ERROR'.

Operators

+ - * / % // **, comparisons (numeric when both sides parse as numbers, trimmed-string otherwise), || and juxtaposition concat, & |, unary \.

Part 2. The COBOL language

Part 2 begins here. Bricks ships a free-form COBOL interpreter (cobol/) that sits beside REXX as a second front end on the same EXEC CICS / EXEC SQL / EXEC CICS WEB

surface. The chapters that follow describe COBOL source format, the DATA DIVISION, PROCEDURE DIVISION, the EIB binding, the COPY directive (including the standard DFHAID, DFHRESP, SQLCA, and DFHWB* copybooks), and the restrictions. Command-level behaviour is identical between COBOL and REXX — see **Parts 4, 6, and 7** for the verbs.

Chapter 20. COBOL source format

Bricks ships a free-form COBOL interpreter (`cobol/`) that sits beside REXX as a second front end on the same EXEC CICS surface. The language-specific layer is `cobol/frame.go`, which adapts COBOL's group-item world to the REXX-style STEM.TAIL lookup the CICS handlers use.

Source rules

- **Free-form.** No column 1-72 ruling; no Area A / Area B.
- **Hyphens** are allowed in identifiers (CUST-RECORD).
- **Comments** use modern `*>` anywhere on a line, or legacy `*` in column 1.
- **Strings** use `'...'` or `"..."` with quote-doubling for embedded quotes.
- **Hex literals** like `X'F3'` and `X"7C"` decode to their byte value — used for `IF EIBAID = X'F3'` to check PF3 / PF12 / etc. without `C2X(EIBAID) = 'F3'` round-trips.

Divisions

The four divisions parse in their canonical order:

```
IDENTIFICATION DIVISION.
PROGRAM-ID. HELC.

ENVIRONMENT DIVISION.      *> optional, must be empty

DATA DIVISION.
WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.
01 SCR.
   05 INFOLINE PIC X(78).
   05 GREETING PIC X(20).

PROCEDURE DIVISION.
MAIN.
   MOVE 'Hello' TO GREETING.
   EXEC CICS SEND MAP('HEL01') FROM(SCR) ERASE END-EXEC.
   EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC.
STOP RUN.
```

LINKAGE SECTION is not yet parsed; DFHCOMMAREA is auto-injected as `PIC X(2000)` if the program doesn't declare it (see `cobol.ensureSystemItems`), so a sub-program can `MOVE DFHCOMMAREA TO` key immediately. The dispatcher strips trailing space when reading the COBOL frame's DFHCOMMAREA back out, so a fixed-width buffer round-trips cleanly across an inter-language EXEC CICS LINK.

Chapter 21. DATA DIVISION

- **PIC clauses (unedited):** X(n) alphanumeric, 9(n) integer, S9(n) signed, 9(n)V99 decimal (the V is positional; arithmetic uses the fixed-point `decimal` type internally so scale survives MOVE / COMPUTE / DISPLAY).
- **PIC clauses (edited numeric):** five edit characters are recognised:
 - Z — replace a leading zero with a space.
 - . — insert an actual decimal point at that column.
 - , — insert a thousands separator at that column.
 - \$ — insert a \$. A single \$ is *fixed* (always emitted at that column, e.g. \$9999 value 42 → "\$0042"). Two or more in a row *float*: only the rightmost one remains and slides to the position just before the first significant digit (e.g. \$\$,\$\$9.99 value 1234.56 → "\$1,234.56").
 - * — check protection. Replaces a leading zero with * instead of a space (e.g. **,**9.99 value 12.34 → "****12.34").

At most one suppression family per PIC: Z, floating \$, and * are mutually exclusive (a single fixed \$ is fine with Z or with *). MOVEing a scaled numeric source through an edited receiver honours the source's V-scale: MOVE N TO N-Z where N is PIC 9(5)V99 VALUE 12345.67 and N-Z is PIC ZZ,ZZ9.99 stores "12,345.67". The other ANSI edit characters (+ - CR DB B 0 / BLANK WHEN ZERO) are not yet supported.

- **VALUE:** VALUE 'literal', VALUE 42, VALUE SPACES, VALUE ZEROS, VALUE HIGH-VALUES, VALUE LOW-VALUES, VALUE QUOTES.
- **Level 88 condition-names:** 88 NAME VALUE 'X'., VALUES 'A', 'B', 'C'., or VALUE 'A' THRU 'Z'. The 88-level attaches to the immediately preceding non-88 data item and declares a boolean condition that is true when that item's current value matches one of the listed values (or falls inside a THRU range). Reference as a bare name from PROCEDURE DIVISION — see Chapter 22 “88-level condition names”.
- **Group items:**
 - 01 PARENT.
 - 05 CHILD PIC X(8).
 - 05 OTHER PIC X(4).

Children are stored as offsets into a single parent buffer, so MOVE to the parent fans out and EXEC CICS SEND MAP FROM(PARENT) walks the children for field values.

- **Data names can be reused across groups.** A child name that appears under more than one group is fine; the parser accepts the declaration and tracks the collision in `Program.AmbiguousNames`. Unqualified access to such a name is a runtime error (“ambiguous reference”) — disambiguate with OF (or its synonym IN):

```
01 SCR.  
    05 CUSTNO PIC X(8).  
01 DET.  
    05 CUSTNO PIC X(8).  
...  
MOVE 'A1234567' TO CUSTNO OF SCR.
```

```
MOVE 'B7654321' TO CUSTNO OF DET.  
DISPLAY CUSTNO OF SCR.
```

Single-step qualification (`X OF Y`) picks the matching child anywhere in `Y`'s subtree; multi-step (`X OF Y OF Z`) chains through nested groups. Bare names that are unique across the program continue to work without qualification — the pre-7 `runtime/cobol/gust.cob` convention of prefixed child names (`DCUSTNO`, `DNAME`, `DMSG`) still compiles and runs, it just isn't required any more.

A sibling-duplicate (two children of the `SAME` parent sharing a name) is still a parse-time error — no qualifier can disambiguate between siblings of one group.

Chapter 22. PROCEDURE DIVISION

Statements supported

`MOVE`, `DISPLAY`, `STOP RUN`, `GOBACK`, `EXIT`, `EXIT PROGRAM`, `CONTINUE` (no-op), `IF ... [ELSE] ... END-IF`, `EVALUATE` subject `WHEN` value [`WHEN` value] ... [`WHEN OTHER`] ... `END-EVALUATE`, `PERFORM` para, `PERFORM` para `UNTIL` cond, `PERFORM` para `N TIMES`, `PERFORM` para `VARYING` idx `FROM` x `BY` y `UNTIL` cond, `GO TO` para, `COMPUTE` target [`ROUNDED`] = expr [`ON SIZE ERROR ... END-COMPUTE`], `ADD` a `TO` b [`GIVING` c] [`ROUNDED`] [`ON SIZE ERROR ... END-ADD`], `SUBTRACT` a `FROM` b [`GIVING` c] [`ROUNDED`] [`ON SIZE ERROR ... END-SUBTRACT`], `MULTIPLY` a `BY` b [`GIVING` c] [`ROUNDED`] [`ON SIZE ERROR ... END-MULTIPLY`], `DIVIDE` a `INTO` b [`GIVING` c] [`ROUNDED`] [`ON SIZE ERROR ... END-DIVIDE`], `DIVIDE` a `BY` b `GIVING` c [`ROUNDED`] [`ON SIZE ERROR ... END-DIVIDE`], `STRING ... DELIMITED BY` (`SIZE` | `'lit'`) `INTO` target `END-STRING`, `UNSTRING` source `DELIMITED BY` `'lit'` `INTO` t1 t2 ... `END-UNSTRING`, `INSPECT` subject `TALLYING` counter `FOR` (`ALL` | `LEADING` | `CHARACTERS`) [needle] [`BEFORE/AFTER INITIAL` delim], `INSPECT` subject `REPLACING` (`ALL` | `LEADING` | `FIRST` | `CHARACTERS`) [needle] `BY` replacement [`BEFORE/AFTER INITIAL` delim], `EXEC CICS ... END-EXEC`.

Every target name above (the second operand of `MOVE`, the target of `COMPUTE` / `ADD` / `SUBTRACT` / `MULTIPLY` / `DIVIDE` / `GIVING` / `STRING INTO` / `UNSTRING INTO` / `INSPECT`, and the subject of `EVALUATE` / `IF`) accepts qualification via `OF` / `IN` (see the Data Division section on globally non-unique names) and subscripts via (`idx`) for `OCCURS`-resident items.

ROUNDED and ON SIZE ERROR

`ROUNDED` applied to `COMPUTE` and the four arithmetic verbs rounds the final value half-away-from-zero to the destination's PIC scale instead of truncating toward zero (the un`ROUNDED` default).

`ON SIZE ERROR` runs its statement list when the calculation overflows the int64 fixed-point engine, the result's integer-part digits don't fit in the target PIC, or a `DIVIDE` divisor is zero; when present, the destination is left untouched on a size-error firing. Without an `ON SIZE ERROR` branch the value is silently truncated/wrapped as before so existing programs aren't disrupted.

PERFORM N TIMES and PERFORM VARYING

```
PERFORM FILL-ROW 15 TIMES.
```

```
PERFORM FILL-ROW  
  VARYING I FROM 1 BY 1 UNTIL I > 15.
```


PERFORM ... N TIMES runs the named paragraph exactly N times; N can be a numeric literal or a numeric data item. **PERFORM ... VARYING idx FROM x BY y UNTIL cond** initialises idx to x, runs the body while cond is false, then increments idx by y between iterations.

OCCURS arrays

```
01 TABLE-AREA.
    05 ROW OCCURS 15 TIMES.
        10 K PIC X(8).
        10 N PIC X(28).
01 I PIC 9(4).
...
MOVE 'KEY-A' TO K(1).
MOVE 'KEY-B' TO K(I).
PERFORM SHOW-ROW VARYING I FROM 1 BY 1 UNTIL I > 15.
```

OCCURS n TIMES declares n copies of an item; references add a parenthesised 1-based subscript expression that picks one. The subscript can be any numeric expression — a literal, a data item, or arithmetic — and is bounds-checked at runtime. Subscripts work on group items (**ROW(5)**) and on elementaries inside the **OCCURS** group (**K(5)**) alike. The cap is 4096 occurrences per item; nested **OCCURS** (an **OCCURS** group inside another **OCCURS** group) is rejected at parse time.

Periods

Periods are scope-terminators, not per-statement: a statement inside an **IF ... END-IF** body has no period; only the unscoped statement at the paragraph level does.

Postfix NOT

IBM-style postfix **NOT** (**X NOT = Y**, **X NOT > Y**) is supported in **IF** / **EVALUATE** / **PERFORM UNTIL** conditions.

Relational operators

Both symbolic and English-spelled relational operators are accepted in **IF**, **EVALUATE WHEN**, and **PERFORM UNTIL** conditions. The two styles are interchangeable; legacy CICS applications typically use the English spelling.

The optional words **IS**, **THAN**, and **TO** are noise — present or omitted without changing meaning. **NOT** may prefix any operator and appears before or after **IS** (**IF X IS NOT EQUAL TO Y**).

Meaning	Symbolic	English-spelled forms (noise words bracketed)
equal	=	[IS] EQUAL [TO]
not equal	<>, NOT =	[IS] NOT EQUAL [TO]
greater	>	[IS] GREATER [THAN]
not greater ()	NOT >	[IS] NOT GREATER [THAN]
less	<	[IS] LESS [THAN]
not less ()	NOT <	[IS] NOT LESS [THAN]

Meaning	Symbolic	English-spelled forms (noise words bracketed)
greater or equal	>=	[IS] GREATER [THAN] OR EQUAL [T0]
less or equal	<=	[IS] LESS [THAN] OR EQUAL [T0]

The four lines below are equivalent — all four compile to the same comparison and run identically:

```
IF WK-MTH = 7          DISPLAY 'JULY'.
IF WK-MTH EQUAL 7      DISPLAY 'JULY'.
IF WK-MTH EQUAL TO 7   DISPLAY 'JULY'.
IF WK-MTH IS EQUAL TO 7 DISPLAY 'JULY'.
```

Class condition tests

X IS [NOT] {NUMERIC | ALPHABETIC | ALPHABETIC-UPPER | ALPHABETIC-LOWER} tests the current **byte contents** of a data item against a character class — not its static PIC class. A PIC 9(4) field holding 0000 is NUMERIC; the same field after a partial move that injects letters is not.

IS is optional noise; NOT negates as in any other condition.

```
IF WS-INPUT IS NUMERIC
    PERFORM CALC
ELSE
    DISPLAY 'NON-NUMERIC INPUT'.
IF WS-NAME IS ALPHABETIC
    PERFORM ACCEPT-NAME.
```

ALPHABETIC accepts uppercase letters, lowercase letters, and space. ALPHABETIC-UPPER and ALPHABETIC-LOWER restrict to their case (plus space). For PIC S9 signed numerics the byte 0 sign position is allowed to hold ' ', '+', or '-'.

Sign condition tests

X IS [NOT] {POSITIVE | NEGATIVE | ZERO} tests the numeric sign of a numeric expression. The operand must be a numeric data item (PIC 9... or PIC S9...) or a numeric expression; a sign test on a non-numeric operand is a runtime error rather than a silent false.

```
IF WS-BALANCE IS NEGATIVE
    DISPLAY 'OVERDRAWN'.
IF AMOUNT IS ZERO
    PERFORM SKIP-ENTRY.
```

Signed zero is neither POSITIVE nor NEGATIVE; an unsigned PIC (PIC 9... without S) can never be NEGATIVE — that short-circuits to false without inspecting the value.

88-level condition names

A level-88 line in DATA DIVISION declares a boolean condition tied to the **preceding non-88 data item**. The condition is true when the parent's current value matches one of the listed values

or falls within a THRU range. Reference as a bare name in any PROCEDURE DIVISION condition.

```
DATA DIVISION.
WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.
01 RESP-CODE PIC 9(3).
   88 RESP-OK          VALUE 0.
   88 RESP-MISSING     VALUE 13.
   88 RESP-RECOVER     VALUES 12, 26, 80.
   88 RESP-FATAL       VALUE 100 THRU 999.
PROCEDURE DIVISION.
MAIN.
   EXEC CICS READ FILE('CUSTOMER')
              INTO(REC) RIDFLD(KEY)
              RESP(RESP-CODE) END-EXEC.

   IF RESP-OK
      CONTINUE
   ELSE IF RESP-RECOVER
      PERFORM RETRY
   ELSE IF RESP-FATAL
      PERFORM ABEND.
```

VALUES (plural) and VALUE (singular) are interchangeable. Multiple values may be separated by commas or by spaces. THRU (synonym THROUGH) declares an inclusive range; ranges and single values can be mixed in one declaration: 88 OK VALUES 0, 1 THRU 5, 9.

Comparison style follows the parent's PIC class — numeric parents compare numerically, alphanumeric parents compare byte-by-byte (after rstripping trailing spaces). NOT and the AND/OR connectives compose normally: IF NOT RESP-OK OR RESP-FATAL.

A condition-name lives in its own namespace, separate from data items — 01 STATUS PIC X. and 88 STATUS-OK VALUE 'Y'. are two different lookups. Declaring an 88 whose name collides with an existing data item is rejected at parse time.

Intrinsic functions

The shipped intrinsic library is:

Function	Args	Result
FUNCTION UPPER-CASE(s)	1 alphanumeric	s uppercased.
FUNCTION LOWER-CASE(s)	1 alphanumeric	s lowercased.
FUNCTION TRIM(s)	1 alphanumeric	s with leading and trailing spaces removed (both ends; one-arg form).
FUNCTION REVERSE(s)	1 alphanumeric	s reversed (rune-aware).
FUNCTION LENGTH(s)	1 alphanumeric	numeric byte length of the operand's storage (PIC X(8) → 8).

Function	Args	Result
FUNCTION NUMVAL(s)	1 alphanumeric	numeric value of s after stripping leading / trailing whitespace; errors on non-numeric content (does not silently coerce to zero).
FUNCTION POS(needle, haystack)	2 alphanumeric	1-based byte position of needle in haystack, or 0 when not found. Mirrors REXX's POS(). Empty needle returns 0.

Numeric-returning intrinsics (LENGTH, NUMVAL, POS) participate in IF / EVALUATE / arithmetic comparisons as numeric operands, so IF FUNCTION POS(NEEDLE, HAY) > 0 works without an intermediate COMPUTE. The remaining intrinsics return alphanumeric and compare by bytes (rstriped).

FUNCTION POS is the substring-search hook used by runtime/cobol/gusl.cob to filter the customers file when the operator types a search term at GUST's S action.

INSPECT

```
INSPECT subject TALLYING counter FOR (ALL | LEADING | CHARACTERS)
                                [needle] [BEFORE/AFTER INITIAL delim]
                                [, ...]
INSPECT subject REPLACING (ALL | LEADING | FIRST | CHARACTERS)
                                [needle] BY replacement
                                [BEFORE/AFTER INITIAL delim]
                                [, ...]
```

Quantifiers:

- **ALL** — every occurrence of *needle* (TALLYING) or every occurrence rewritten (REPLACING).
- **LEADING** — only successive occurrences at the start of the in-scope region.
- **FIRST** — only the first occurrence (REPLACING only).
- **CHARACTERS** — every character in the in-scope region; for TALLYING this just counts characters, for REPLACING it overwrites each one with the first byte of *replacement*.

Limiters:

- **BEFORE INITIAL delim** narrows the in-scope region to everything before the first occurrence of *delim*.
- **AFTER INITIAL delim** narrows to everything after the first occurrence of *delim*.

Both can be set on the same phrase; AFTER picks the start, BEFORE picks the end.

Multiple phrases can be combined per statement, optionally separated by commas:

```
INSPECT REC REPLACING ALL ',' BY '|' ALL ';' BY '/'.
INSPECT REC TALLYING C FOR LEADING '0', ALL 'X' AFTER INITIAL ' '.
```

Counter behaviour: **TALLYING accumulates** — successive **INSPECT TALLYING** statements add to the existing counter value rather than resetting, matching IBM semantics. **REPLACING** phrases run left-to- right in declared order, so later phrases see the output of earlier ones.

Subject, counter, and operands all accept qualified data-names (**INSPECT REC OF DET ...**). Trailing **PIC X** padding is rstripped from both the subject and the needle before matching, so a 30-byte filter containing **F00** plus trailing spaces matches against the meaningful content of the subject rather than against the padding.

IBM's **CONVERTING** form is not parsed yet.

EVALUATE limitations

EVALUATE only supports the simple value form. **EVALUATE TRUE / EVALUATE FALSE** is rejected at parse time with a hint to rewrite as **IF/ELSE** — those forms (and **WHEN ... THRU ...** ranges, multi-subject **ALSO** clauses, condition-name arms) are deferred.

Chapter 23. The EIB block in COBOL

EIBRESP, **EIBRESP2**, **EIBAID**, **EIBCPASN**, **EIBCALEN**, **EIBTRMID**, **RC**, and **DFHCOMMAREA** are auto-injected if not declared, so most programs need no boilerplate. After every **EXEC CICS**, **EIBRESP** and **EIBRESP2** are populated by the handler the same way they are for **REXX**. The legacy “test **EIBRESP** after every verb” pattern is the most common idiom; for non-local error handling without a **REXX**-style **SIGNAL ON ERROR**, use **EXEC CICS HANDLE CONDITION / EXEC CICS HANDLE ABEND** (Chapter 10).

See Chapter 11 for the field meanings.

Chapter 24. EXEC CICS in COBOL

The COBOL parser collects every token between **EXEC CICS** and **END-EXEC** and reconstructs the body verbatim for the same **cics.ParseCommand** **REXX** uses. Three consequences:

- **Map-field names must match group-child names exactly.** When **EXEC CICS SEND MAP('CUST1') FROM(SCR)** fires, the CICS handler asks the frame for **SCR.INFOLINE**, **SCR.MSG**, etc. — so **SCR** must have children spelled exactly as the map declares fields. Real COBOL solves this with BMS-generated copybooks; bricks doesn't ship those, so the operator declares fields by hand.
- **DFHCOMMAREA is the COMMAREA marshalling slot.** Caller passes bytes in via the frame; sub-program reads with **MOVE DFHCOMMAREA TO ...**, mutates a working copy, and **MOVE ... TO DFHCOMMAREA**. Trailing space is stripped by the dispatcher on the way back out.
- **Command-line arguments arrive via EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(...).** When the operator types **EXAM 1 2 3** at the blank prompt, the dispatcher hands the unedited line (**TRANSID** prefix included) to the first task in the chain. The program reads it with **EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(WS-INPUT) LENGTH(WS-LEN) END-EXEC** and parses with **UNSTRING WS-INPUT DELIMITED BY ' ' INTO TRANSID A B C END-UNSTRING**. Single-shot per task, then **E0C**. See `runtime/cobol/exam.cob`.

EXEC CICS SEND TEXT FROM(area) [ERASE] works the same way. Reconstruction routes through the shared `cics.Handler`, so any verb REXX can issue, COBOL can issue too. The body is laid out as a flat row-major buffer (every `cols` bytes = one row, default 80) — 3270 has no LF, so build `area` as a group of PIC X(80) children and fill them row by row, or compose a single PIC X(n*80) with a matching MOVE per row.

The full EXEC CICS verb set is documented in Part 2; behaviour is identical between REXX and COBOL.

Chapter 25. Copybooks

A copybook is a fragment of COBOL source — typically declarations for constants and groups — kept in a separate file and pulled into a program at parse time with a single line:

```
WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.  
COPY DFHAID.  
COPY DFHRESP.  
01 OWN-COUNTER PIC 9(4).
```

`bricks` expands every `COPY name.` directive at the source-text level before the lexer runs, so the rest of the parser sees one unbroken stream of COBOL.

The COPY directive

Syntax:

```
COPY <name>.
```

- The directive must be on its own line. Anything before or after the `COPY` keyword on the same line is a parse error.
- `<name>` is the basename of a copybook file; leave the extension off. The lookup tries `<name>.cpy`, then `<name>.cbl`, then the exact `<name>`, all case-insensitive.
- The trailing period is required.
- Leading whitespace is tolerated, and an `*>` inline comment on the same line is fine: `COPY DFHAID. *> 3270 AID bytes.`
- The directive is case-insensitive (`COPY`, `Copy`, `copy` all work), and so is the name (`COPY DFHAID.` and `copy dfhaid.` resolve to the same file).

Where bricks searches

The search directory is configured by `copybook_dir=` in `bricks.cnf`. The default is `runtime/cobolcopy/` (auto-derived from `runtime_dir` when that line is set). The standard CICS copybooks ship under this directory, so a fresh install already has `DFHAID.cpy` and `DFHRESP.cpy` available.

Copybook names are restricted to a flat alphanumeric namespace: `A-Z`, `a-z`, `0-9`, `-`, `_`, and `..`. Names containing a path separator, a `..` sequence, or a leading dot are rejected before any filesystem access. A copybook itself may contain `COPY` directives; nesting is capped at depth 5 and cycles are detected explicitly.

Delivered copybook: DFHAID

`COPY DFHAID.` brings in the standard 3270 attention-identifier (AID) byte constants. Every AID is declared **twice**, once under the friendly bricks mnemonic and once under the IBM-traditional `DFH` alias — both names resolve to the same byte, and a program may use either style or mix them.

bricks mnemonic	IBM alias	AID byte	Key
ENTER	DFHENTER	X'7D'	Enter
CLEAR	DFHCLEAR	X'6D'	Clear
PA1	DFHPA1	X'6C'	PA1
PA2	DFHPA2	X'6E'	PA2
PA3	DFHPA3	X'6B'	PA3
PF01	DFHPPF1	X'F1'	PF1
PF02	DFHPPF2	X'F2'	PF2
PF03	DFHPPF3	X'F3'	PF3
PF04	DFHPPF4	X'F4'	PF4
PF05	DFHPPF5	X'F5'	PF5
PF06	DFHPPF6	X'F6'	PF6
PF07	DFHPPF7	X'F7'	PF7
PF08	DFHPPF8	X'F8'	PF8
PF09	DFHPPF9	X'F9'	PF9
PF10	DFHPPF10	X'7A'	PF10
PF11	DFHPPF11	X'7B'	PF11
PF12	DFHPPF12	X'7C'	PF12
PF13	DFHPPF13	X'C1'	PF13
PF14	DFHPPF14	X'C2'	PF14
PF15	DFHPPF15	X'C3'	PF15
PF16	DFHPPF16	X'C4'	PF16
PF17	DFHPPF17	X'C5'	PF17
PF18	DFHPPF18	X'C6'	PF18
PF19	DFHPPF19	X'C7'	PF19
PF20	DFHPPF20	X'C8'	PF20
PF21	DFHPPF21	X'C9'	PF21
PF22	DFHPPF22	X'4A'	PF22
PF23	DFHPPF23	X'4B'	PF23
PF24	DFHPPF24	X'4C'	PF24

The bricks mnemonic uses uniform-width `PF01..PF24`; the IBM alias keeps the no-leading-zero form (`DFHPPF1..DFHPPF24`) everyone recognises from real CICS code.

Delivered copybook: DFHRESP

`COPY DFHRESP.` brings in the EXEC CICS condition-code constants for `EIBRESP`. Each code is declared twice as well — `RESP-X` mnemonic and `DFHRESP-X` traditional alias. Numeric values match the runtime's emitter table (`cics/resp.go`), so any code bricks returns from a verb has a named constant here.

The most useful entries:

bricks mnemonic	IBM alias	EIBRESP	Condition
RESP-NORMAL	DFHRESP-NORMAL	0	success
RESP-ERROR	DFHRESP-ERROR	1	generic error
RESP-EOC	DFHRESP-EOC	6	end-of-chain / nothing to RECEIVE
RESP-NOTFND	DFHRESP-NOTFND	13	record / item / file not found
RESP-DUPREC	DFHRESP-DUPREC	14	duplicate record on WRITE
RESP-DUPKEY	DFHRESP-DUPKEY	15	duplicate key in browse
RESP-INVREQ	DFHRESP-INVREQ	16	invalid request (bad args, sandbox violation)
RESP-IOERR	DFHRESP-IOERR	17	underlying I/O failure
RESP-NOSPACE	DFHRESP-NOSPACE	18	TS / TD queue full
RESP-NOTOPEN	DFHRESP-NOTOPEN	19	file not open / dataset not enabled
RESP-ENDFILE	DFHRESP-ENDFILE	20	end of browse
RESP-LENGERR	DFHRESP-LENGERR	22	length mismatch
RESP-QZERO	DFHRESP-QZERO	23	TS / TD queue empty (READQ TD returns this)
RESP-ITEMERR	DFHRESP-ITEMERR	26	TS item number out of range
RESP-PGMIDERR	DFHRESP-PGMIDERR	27	LINK / XCTL program not found
RESP-MAPFAIL	DFHRESP-MAPFAIL	36	RECEIVE MAP with no input
RESP-INVMPSZ	DFHRESP-INVMPSZ	38	map size mismatch
RESP-QIDERR	DFHRESP-QIDERR	44	TS queue id unknown
RESP-ROLLEDBACK	DFHRESP-ROLLEDBACK	82	unit-of-work rolled back

The full list (every code bricks emits) is in `runtime/cobolcopy/DFHRESP.cpy`. Open the file to see the codes not summarised above (RESP-ILLOGIC, RESP-SIGNAL, RESP-QBUSY, the various RESP-INV... codes, RESP-SYSIDERR, etc.).

Delivered copybook: SQLCA

COPY SQLCA. brings in named constants for SQLCODE and the most common SQLSTATE values, so embedded-SQL programs can write:

```
COPY SQLCA.
...
EXEC SQL SELECT name INTO :NM
      FROM customers WHERE id = :CUSTID END-EXEC.
```



```

EVALUATE SQLCODE
    WHEN SQL-OK             PERFORM SHOW-ROW
    WHEN SQL-NODATA         PERFORM SHOW-NOT-FOUND
    WHEN SQL-MULTIPLEROWS   PERFORM SHOW-AMBIGUOUS
    WHEN OTHER               PERFORM SHOW-SQL-ERROR
END-EVALUATE.

```

The SQLCA fields themselves (SQLCODE, SQLSTATE, SQLERRMC) are auto-injected by the bricks COBOL parser — no COPY needed for the data items. SQLCA only adds the constants programs compare against.

bricks mnemonic	IBM alias	SQLCODE	Meaning
SQL-OK	DB2-SUCCESS	0	success
SQL-NODATA	DB2-NOTFOUND	+100	no row / end-of-cursor
SQL-NOTFND	DB2-NOTFOUND	+100	alias
SQL-NOCONFIG	—	-1	SQL not configured in bricks.cnf
SQL-DDLREJECTED	—	-2	DDL rejected (CEDA-only)
SQL-GENERIC	—	-100	generic PG error (see SQLERRMC + log)
SQL-MULTIPLEROWS	DB2-DUPLICATE	-811	SELECT INTO returned >1 row

SQLSTATE constants are PIC X(5) and compare directly:

```

IF SQLSTATE = SQLSTATE-DUP-KEY THEN
    MOVE 'Already exists.' TO MSG
END-IF.

```

Constant	SQLSTATE	Class
SQLSTATE-OK	00000	success
SQLSTATE-NODATA	02000	no-data
SQLSTATE-WARNING	01000	warning
SQLSTATE-NOT-NULL	23502	NOT NULL constraint violated
SQLSTATE-FK-VIOL	23503	foreign-key constraint violated
SQLSTATE-UQ-VIOL	23505	UNIQUE constraint violated
SQLSTATE-DUP-KEY	23505	alias
SQLSTATE-CHK-VIOL	23514	CHECK constraint violated
SQLSTATE-CONN-FAIL	08001	unable to connect to PG
SQLSTATE-CONN-LOST	08006	connection dropped mid-flight
SQLSTATE-INV-AUTH	28000	PG authentication failed
SQLSTATE-INV-PWD	28P01	wrong password
SQLSTATE-SYNTAX	42601	SQL syntax error
SQLSTATE-UNDEF-TBL	42P01	table doesn't exist

Constant	SQLSTATE	Class
SQLSTATE-UNDEF-COL	42703	column doesn't exist
SQLSTATE-UNDEF-FN	42883	function doesn't exist
SQLSTATE-AMBIG-COL	42702	ambiguous column reference
SQLSTATE-INSUF-PRIV	42501	permission denied

The bricks SQL executor also logs every non-zero `SQLCODE`'s full PG error text via `brickslog.Sys` (one line on the operator console + the per-run log file). Programs render only the short mnemonic-driven message on the 3270 screen; the diagnostic detail lives in the log so PG hostnames / port numbers / wrapper text don't leak to terminal users.

Idiom: replacing raw literals

Before — opaque hex and bare integers, easy to mis-key:

```

IF EIBAID = X'F3' THEN
    MOVE 'Y' TO EXIT-FLAG
END-IF.
IF EIBRESP = 13 THEN
    MOVE 'Customer not found.' TO MSG
END-IF.
IF EIBRESP = 23 THEN          *> TD queue empty
    MOVE 'Y' TO DONE-FLAG
END-IF.

```

After — names a reader can scan:

```

WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.
COPY DFHAID.
COPY DFHRESP.
...
IF EIBAID = PF03 THEN          *> or DFHPF3 if you prefer
    MOVE 'Y' TO EXIT-FLAG
END-IF.
IF EIBRESP = RESP-NOTFND THEN
    MOVE 'Customer not found.' TO MSG
END-IF.
IF EIBRESP = RESP-QZERO THEN
    MOVE 'Y' TO DONE-FLAG
END-IF.

```

Live examples: `qagc.cob` (PF03 cancel branch), `gus1.cob` (EVALUATE EIBAID with PF03 / PF07 / PF08 / PF12), `ordr.cob` (RESP-QZERO and RESP-DUPREC against READQ TD / WRITE FILE), `exam.cob` (RESP-E0C after RECEIVE). All under `runtime/cobol/`.

Restrictions

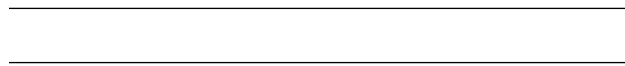
The bricks COPY preprocessor is deliberately minimal. The following real-CICS extensions are **not** supported:

- `COPY ... REPLACING ==X== BY ==Y==.` — token substitution. Rare in modern code; deferred until a concrete use case appears.
- `COPY xyz OF DFHCOB. / COPY xyz IN libname.` — library qualifier. bricks has one search root per process.
- `COPY xyz SUPPRESS.` — suppress copybook listing. bricks produces no listing to suppress.
- Embedded directives: multiple statements on one line including a `COPY` are rejected. The line must be `COPY <name>.` and nothing else.

If a copybook is edited, programs that include it will pick up the new contents only after the program's own source mtime changes (the program cache keys by the program path + mtime, not the copybook's). A trivial way to force a reload is to touch the COBOL file:

```
touch runtime/cobol/qagc.cob
```

Or use `CEMT P C` from a TSO/3270 session to flush the entire program cache.



Part 6. EXEC SQL command reference

Part 6 begins here. The chapter that follows is the complete EXEC SQL surface — identical for COBOL and REXX. It covers every embedded-SQL verb Bricks supports, the SQLCA layout and SQLCODE catalogue, the `WHENEVER` declarative error handler, cursor lifecycle, per-task `CONNECT TO`, null indicators, and SYNCPOINT integration with the bricks unit of work.

Chapter 26. Embedded SQL (COBOL and REXX)

Programming Note. Although this chapter was originally written against COBOL, every EXEC SQL shape and behaviour described here applies identically to REXX. The REXX-specific notes appear later in the chapter under *REXX equivalent*. Programs in either language read and write the SQLCA fields (`SQLCODE`, `SQLSTATE`, `SQLERRMC`) the same way the COBOL samples do.

bricks accepts the classic IBM-style `EXEC SQL ... END-EXEC` embedded-SQL surface and runs it against the Postgres connection configured via `db_*` in `bricks.cnf` (see SQL support — Phase 1). Programs read and write rows through prepared statements; the SQLCA fields `SQLCODE`, `SQLSTATE`, `SQLERRMC` are auto-injected into every program's DATA DIVISION so the program can test them without declaring them.

Scope: single-row CRUD (`SELECT INTO`, `INSERT`, `UPDATE`, `DELETE`, `COMMIT`, `ROLLBACK`), the four-verb cursor lifecycle (`DECLARE / OPEN / FETCH / CLOSE`), per-task `CONNECT TO 'name'` database switching, null indicators (`:hostvar :indicator`), and the `WHENEVER` declarative error-handling directive. The same surface works identically in COBOL and REXX.

Format

```
EXEC SQL <statement> END-EXEC.
```

Where <statement> is any of the supported verbs (below). Host variables are written with a leading colon: :CUSTID, :NM, :BALANCE. The variable name must already exist in DATA DIVISION — the SQL executor reads its current value (for INPUT bindings) and writes back (for SELECT INTO targets).

Supported verbs

Verb	Notes
SELECT cols INTO :v, :v FROM ...	Single-row read. Returns +100 (no-data) when 0 rows, -811 when >1 row.
INSERT INTO t (...) VALUES (...)	Host-variable references bound as \$N placeholders.
UPDATE t SET ... WHERE ...	Returns RESP-NORMAL even when 0 rows match (matches DB2).
DELETE FROM t WHERE ...	Same row-count semantics as UPDATE.
COMMIT WORK	Commits the per-task PG transaction. Also fired by EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT.
ROLLBACK WORK	Rolls back. Also fired by EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK.

DDL (CREATE DATABASE, DROP DATABASE, CREATE USER, DROP USER, ALTER ROLE, CREATE TABLESPACE, ...) is **rejected** with SQLCODE = -2 and SQLSTATE = 42501. CEDA DATABASE owns those operations and audits each one through brickslog.Audit. CREATE TABLE / ALTER TABLE / similar non-privileged DDL is not blocked but is also unsupported in the executor's statement classification — porters should run schema migrations with `psql`.

SQLCODE catalog

bricks adopts the IBM DB2 convention adapted to Postgres. The catalog below covers what programs typically test:

SQLCODE	SQLSTATE	Meaning
0	00000	Success.
+100	02000	No data: SELECT INTO returned 0 rows, or an update/delete affected 0 rows.
-1	empty	No database configured (no db_* lines in bricks.cnf).
-2	42501	DDL rejected (CEDA owns CREATE/DROP DATABASE)
-100	varies	Generic SQL failure — PG returned an error not specifically mapped.

SQLCODE	SQLSTATE	Meaning
-811	21000	SELECT INTO returned more than one row.

SQLERRMC always carries the human-readable message from Postgres (truncated to 70 chars to match the PIC X(70) auto-injection). When the error path includes a specific SQLSTATE, that 5-char code lands in SQLSTATE; otherwise SQLSTATE is the relevant standard code (00000 on success, 02000 on no-data, HV000 when the failure didn't carry a state).

SYNCPOINT integration

Each task lazily begins a Postgres transaction on its first EXEC SQL that touches data. The transaction commits when:

- EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT runs.
- EXEC SQL COMMIT WORK runs.
- The task ends cleanly (RETURN, GOBACK, STOP RUN).

And rolls back when:

- EXEC CICS SYNCPOINT ROLLBACK runs.
- EXEC SQL ROLLBACK WORK runs.
- The task abends via EXEC CICS ABEND.

Postgres-side commit fires *before* the bricks-side bbolt journal commit. That ordering avoids a hung PG commit leaving the bricks journal already finalised; failures during the SQL commit surface as ROLLEDBACK from SYNCPOINT, and the bricks journal then rolls back too.

Idiomatic test

```
EXEC SQL
    SELECT name INTO :NM
    FROM customers_sql
    WHERE id = :CUSTID
END-EXEC.

EVALUATE SQLCODE
    WHEN RESP-NORMAL    PERFORM SHOW-NAME      *> +0
    WHEN RESP-NOTFND    PERFORM SHOW-NOTFOUND   *> wait -- that's an EIBRESP code; SQLCODE uses RE
    WHEN OTHER          PERFORM SHOW-SQL-ERR
END-EVALUATE.
```

The RESP-NORMAL constant (from COPY DFHRESP) is value 0, the same as the SQLCODE-OK value, so it conveniently doubles as the success test for both EIBRESP (EXEC CICS) and SQLCODE (EXEC SQL). For the no-data case, test SQLCODE = +100 directly — there's no DFHSQLCODE copybook yet.

Worked example: SQLD

runtime/cobol/sqlc.cob (TRANSID SQLD) is the bundled demonstration. It reads a single customers_sql row by id and renders the name + SQLCA verdict on screen SQLD1. The expected schema is documented in the program header. The operator runs psql once to seed the table:

```
CREATE TABLE customers_sql (  
    id    text PRIMARY KEY,  
    name text NOT NULL  
);  
INSERT INTO customers_sql VALUES  
    ('K001', 'Alice'),  
    ('K002', 'Bob'),  
    ('K003', 'Carol');
```

Then bricks → sign on → SQLD → type K001 → ENTER. The operator sees Alice in the NM cell with SQLCODE = 0 and SQLSTATE = 00000.

REXX equivalent

REXX programs use the same EXEC SQL shape as COBOL, with :name binding REXX variables. There's no DATA DIVISION analog – REXX is dynamically typed – so SQLCODE, SQLSTATE, SQLERRMC arrive as ordinary REXX variables the program reads after each statement:

```
ADDRESS CICS
```

```
CUSTID = 'K001'
```

```
EXEC SQL
```

```
    SELECT name INTO :NM
```

```
    FROM customers_sql
```

```
    WHERE id = :CUSTID
```

```
END-EXEC
```

```
IF SQLCODE = 0 THEN
```

```
    SAY 'Customer:' NM
```

```
ELSE IF SQLCODE = 100 THEN
```

```
    SAY 'Not found'
```

```
ELSE
```

```
    SAY 'SQL error' SQLCODE ':' SQLERRMC
```

Behind the scenes the REXX preprocessor (rexex.PreprocessExecCICS) rewrites the EXEC SQL block into a sentinel bare-string that runCommand recognises and routes to the same per-task SQL executor COBOL uses. The two language surfaces are parity-clean: the executor doesn't know or care which language drove it. Live sample: runtime/rexx/sqlr.rexx, TRANSID SQLR.

REXX stem-tail gotcha. Classic REXX resolves STEM.NAME by looking up the simple symbol NAME and using its value as the tail. If a program does EXEC SQL ... INTO :NM then writes SCR.NM = NM, the LHS resolves to SCR.<value-of-NM> = SCR.Alice — the value lands in the wrong slot. Workaround: pick a host-var name that is NOT also a stem tail. The bundled SQLR uses CUSTNM instead of NM for exactly this reason.

WHENEVER (declarative error handling)

Instead of testing `SQLCODE` after every statement, a program can declare a standing rule with `EXEC SQL WHENEVER`:

```
EXEC SQL WHENEVER SQLERROR  GO TO SQL-ERROR-EXIT END-EXEC.  
EXEC SQL WHENEVER NOT FOUND GO TO NO-MORE-ROWS  END-EXEC.
```

```
EXEC SQL SELECT name INTO :NM FROM customers_sql  
        WHERE id = :CUSTID END-EXEC.
```

**> no SQLCODE test here -- WHENEVER handles it*

Three conditions, checked after every subsequent `EXEC SQL`:

Condition	Fires when
SQLERROR	SQLCODE is negative
NOT FOUND	SQLCODE = +100
SQLWARNING	SQLWARN0 = 'W' (bricks rarely sets this — PG errors rather than warns)

Each condition takes one of two actions:

- `CONTINUE` — ignore the condition, fall through (the default for any condition never declared).
- `GO TO label / GOTO label` — branch to the paragraph (COBOL) or label (REXX). The branch unwinds any enclosing `PERFORM` exactly as an explicit `GO TO` would.

A later `WHENEVER` for the same condition replaces the earlier one (e.g. declare `GO TO` for a block of statements, then `CONTINUE` to resume manual handling).

REXX uses the identical syntax; the branch is a `SIGNAL` to the named label:

```
EXEC SQL WHENEVER SQLERROR GOTO SQLERR END-EXEC  
EXEC SQL SELECT name INTO :CUSTNM FROM customers_sql  
        WHERE id = :CUSTID END-EXEC  
SAY 'customer:' CUSTNM  
EXIT  
SQLERR:  
SAY 'SQL failed, SQLCODE' SQLCODE  
EXIT
```

Scoping caveat. bricks's `WHENEVER` is *execution-order* scoped: the directive set by the most recently **executed** `EXEC SQL WHENEVER` governs later statements. Real DB2 scopes *lexically* (by source position) because its precompiler inlines a `SQLCODE` test after every statement. For the dominant pattern — one `WHENEVER` near the top of the program — the two are identical. Programs that re-declare `WHENEVER` inside conditional branches see execution-order semantics; keep `WHENEVER` declarations at the top of a paragraph to avoid surprises.

Cursors (DECLARE / OPEN / FETCH / CLOSE)

Multi-row result sets use the four-verb cursor lifecycle. The executor parks one `*sql.Rows` per cursor per task; cursors are closed automatically on `COMMIT`, `ROLLBACK`, or task end so a program

that forgets CLOSE doesn't pin Postgres MVCC.

```
EXEC SQL DECLARE C1 CURSOR FOR
    SELECT id, name FROM customers_sql ORDER BY id
END-EXEC.
```

```
EXEC SQL OPEN C1 END-EXEC.
```

```
PERFORM UNTIL SQLCODE = 100
    EXEC SQL FETCH C1 INTO :ID, :NM END-EXEC
    IF SQLCODE = 0 THEN
        DISPLAY 'row: ' ID ' ' NM
    END-IF
END-PERFORM.
```

```
EXEC SQL CLOSE C1 END-EXEC.
```

REXX uses the same four verbs (the preprocessor routes them all through the same executor):

```
EXEC SQL DECLARE C1 CURSOR FOR SELECT id, name FROM customers_sql END-EXEC
EXEC SQL OPEN C1 END-EXEC
DO FOREVER
    EXEC SQL FETCH C1 INTO :ID, :CUSTNM END-EXEC
    IF SQLCODE = 100 THEN LEAVE
    SAY 'row:' ID CUSTNM
END
EXEC SQL CLOSE C1 END-EXEC
```

End-of-data is `SQLCODE = +100`. A closed cursor stays in the registry, so `OPEN c1` can rewind it without `re-DECLARE`.

CONNECT TO 'name' (per-task database switch)

A program that needs to touch a second database during a task issues `EXEC SQL CONNECT TO 'name'`. The named database must exist in `databases.conf` (the CEDA DATABASE catalogue); an unknown name returns `SQLCODE = -1`. An in-flight PG transaction on the previous database is committed implicitly (matches DB2's behaviour) – programs that want to discard the previous work should `EXEC SQL ROLLBACK` before connecting.

```
EXEC SQL CONNECT TO 'orders' END-EXEC.
EXEC SQL INSERT INTO order_lines VALUES (:ID, :QTY) END-EXEC.
EXEC SQL COMMIT END-EXEC.
EXEC SQL CONNECT TO 'customers' END-EXEC.
EXEC SQL SELECT email INTO :EM FROM customers WHERE id = :CID END-EXEC.
```

Implicit binding still applies to the first statement of every task – the transaction's `Database` column in `transactions.conf` picks the starting pool. `CONNECT TO` is only needed when the program needs to move between databases inside a single task.

Null indicators (:hostvar :indicator)

DB2 programs use a second host var beside the value to signal NULL. Bricks supports the same pair syntax in both COBOL and REXX:

```
EXEC SQL
    SELECT name INTO :NM :NIND
    FROM customers_sql WHERE id = :CUSTID
END-EXEC.
```

```
EVALUATE NIND
    WHEN 0    DISPLAY 'Name: ' NM
    WHEN -1   DISPLAY 'Name is NULL'
END-EVALUATE.
```

Output side (SELECT INTO / FETCH INTO):

- Column was non-NULL → indicator = 0, value holds the result.
- Column was NULL → indicator = -1, value is cleared to the empty string so a program that ignored its indicator can't read a stale value from a previous statement.

Input side (WHERE / VALUES / SET clauses):

```
MOVE -1 TO NIND.
EXEC SQL
    INSERT INTO customers_sql (id, name) VALUES (:K, :NM :NIND)
END-EXEC.
```

- Indicator = -1 at bind time → bricks passes NULL to PG, regardless of what NM currently holds.
- Indicator = 0 (or unset) → the value var's frame contents bind normally.

Pair detection: a value/indicator pair is two :name tokens separated only by whitespace. :NM, :NIND (with a comma) means two independent host vars, not a pair. The INDICATOR keyword form (:NM INDICATOR :NIND) is not currently supported – use the juxtaposed form.

Column-value coercion

PG's wire format doesn't always match what COBOL or REXX want to read. Bricks normalises three cases before the value reaches the program's host variable:

- **bool columns** – PG returns "t" / "f" (or "true" / "false"). Bricks converts to "1" / "0" so COBOL PIC X(1) flags and REXX IF VAR = 1 idioms work the way they do in DB2.
- **NUMERIC(p, s) columns** – PG drops trailing fractional zeros for computed expressions (SELECT 1.5 returns "1.5" even though the result type has scale 2). Bricks pads the value to the column's declared scale, so a COBOL PIC 9(3)V99 target receives "1.50" → digits "150" → stored as 001.50, not 000.15.
- **CHAR(N) columns** – PG returns space-padded values. Bricks trims trailing spaces so a REXX literal compare (IF VAR = 'X') doesn't fail because the CHAR(5) value was "X ". VARCHAR is left alone (PG never pads it; its trailing spaces are real).

Other types (INT, BIGINT, TEXT, DATE, TIMESTAMP, JSON, ...) flow through verbatim.

COBOL's MOVE semantics handle integer sign and zero-pad automatically; REXX is dynamically typed so the string form works for both display and arithmetic.

Restrictions

Out of scope	Why
Stored procedure calls (EXEC SQL CALL)	Out of scope — porters use plain SELECT-from-function.
Multi-row INSERT VALUES (...), (...) CREATE / DROP DATABASE USER	Out of scope; rewrite as one statement per row. CEDA DATABASE only (C / X actions, audit-logged).
Long-running cursors across EXEC CICS RETURN chains	Out of scope; each task gets a fresh PG connection.

Chapter 27. Restrictions and deferred features

Disallowed

- **Calculated GOTOs.** GO TO DEPENDING ON is rejected at parse time. The bricks runtime gives every task its own heap and stack with no static control-block aliasing; calculated GOTOs would require a per-program label-table the parser deliberately doesn't build.

Deferred Syntax Coverage

- Reference modification (DATE-FIELD(1:4) for substring access).
- Multi-dimensional OCCURS. One-level OCCURS is supported (see Chapter 22); the parser rejects an OCCURS item whose chain already contains another OCCURS ancestor.
- SCREENHT-based map family suffix (e.g. CUST1L on a mod-4 screen). REXX programs do this with a runtime IF SCRHH >= 43 THEN ... fallback after a MAPFAIL; the COBOL twins always render the unsuffixed mod-2 maps for now.

Part 8. Sample programs

Part 8 begins here. Bricks ships a curated set of REXX and COBOL programs that exercise every command family in the earlier parts. Each transaction has been built to be operator- reachable from the blank prompt and self-explaining when run — reading the source is the fastest way to internalise the bricks programming model.

Chapter 28. Pre-installed sample transactions

COBOL

Transid	File	Notes
HELC	runtime/cobol/hello.cob	Hello-world; SEND MAP('HEL01') FROM(SCR), RETURN. Smallest end-to-end demo.
QAGC	runtime/cobol/qagc.cob	COBOL twin of QAGR (REXX). Validates the QAGE1 birthdate, computes age in years and approximate days, sends QAGR1. Pseudo-conversational redisplay of QAGE1 on validation errors.
GUST	runtime/cobol/gust.cob	COBOL CUST. A=Add, Q=Query, U=Update, D=Delete, L=List, S=Search; the S action LINKs to GUSL with the search term in COMMAREA and renders the match count returned.
GUSV	runtime/cobol/gusv.cob	COBOL twin of CUSV. Validates the customer-number COMMAREA (LINK target).
GUSL	runtime/cobol/gusl.cob	COBOL twin of CUSL. Renders the customers file via STARTBR / READNEXT / ENDBR. Blank inbound COMMAREA = paginated all-records list (PF7/PF8). Non-blank inbound COMMAREA = filtered single-page browse: every record is FUNCTION POS-tested against the upper-cased filter, the first 15 matches populate ROW1..ROW15, and the total match count flows back through DFHCOMMAREA so the caller (GUST) can render a summary.
EXAM	runtime/cobol/exam.cob	Worked example of reading the operator's command-line arguments. Type EXAM 1 2 3 at the blank prompt.

Transid	File	Notes
ORDR	runtime/cobol/ordr.cob	Conversational import: reads run-time/tmp/orders.sample.txt via READQ TD, parses pipe-delimited rows, and WRITE FILE('ORDERS') keyed on customer-id. Tolerates duplicates (EIBRESP = RESP-DUPREC). Summary screen shows counts. See worked example E.
TIMC	runtime/cobol/timc.cob	Timed-reminder demo: exercises CONVERSE, START (with INTERVAL + FROM), and RETRIEVE end-to-end. Shares tim1.map + tim2.map with TIMR.
SQLD	runtime/cobol/sql.d.cob	Embedded-SQL demo: EXEC SQL SELECT name INTO :NM FROM customers_sql WHERE id = :CUSTID. Renders the row + SQLCODE / SQLSTATE / SQLERRMC. Requires Postgres seeded with the schema shown in Chapter 26.
SQLR	runtime/rexx/sqlr.rexx	REXX twin of SQLD. Shares the customers_sql table; demonstrates how REXX accesses the same EXEC SQL surface (SQLCODE / SQLSTATE / SQLERRMC arrive as plain REXX variables).

All five non-trivial COBOL samples (QAGC, GUST, GUSL, ORDR, EXAM) COPY DFHAID and/or COPY DFHRESP instead of hard-coding hex AID bytes or numeric EIBRESP codes. Skim any of them as living examples of the named-constant idiom from Chapter 25.

REXX (selected)

Transid	File	Notes
HELO	runtime/rexx/hello.rexx	Hello-world with system-info pane on mod 4.

Transid	File	Notes
CUST	runtime/rexx/cust.rexx	Full customer maintenance — Add / Query / Update / Delete / List / Search; LINKs to CUSV for validation.
CUSV	runtime/rexx/cusv.rexx	Validation sub-program; called by CUST via EXEC CICS LINK.
CUSL	runtime/rexx/cusl.rexx	Paginated customer list using STARTBR / READNEXT / ENDBR; adapts paging to mod 2 vs mod 4.
QAGE / QAGR	runtime/rexx/qage.rexx / qagr.rexx	Pseudo-conversational chain; QAGE prompts for a birthdate and chains to QAGR to render the result.
PROD / CONS	runtime/rexx/prod.rexx / cons.rexx	TS queue producer / consumer pair. Conversational; PF3 to exit.
GETC	runtime/rexx/getc.rexx	RECEIVE of command-line + READ FILE + SEND TEXT (no map).
TIMR	runtime/rexx/timr.rexx	REXX twin of TIMC: START schedules a reminder; RETRIEVE discriminates cold vs scheduled entry. Shares tim1.map + tim2.map with TIMC.

Transid	File	Notes
CHAT	runtime/rexx/chat.rexx	Real-time multi-user chat. Self-refreshes every 2 seconds via EXEC CICS START TRANSID('CHAT') INTERVAL(000002); the tick handler does SEND MAP ... DATAONLY so the operator's in-progress typing at the bottom of the screen is not clobbered by the refresh. Messages persist in the auto-created KSDS file CHATLOG (one record per message, key shape YYYYMMDDHHMMSS-NNNN-TTTT for lexicographic / chronological sort). Adapts between Model 2 (16 history rows, chatm2.map) and Model 4 (35 history rows, chatm4.map) via EXEC CICS ASSIGN SCREENHT. F3 exits cleanly — no further tick is scheduled, the self-refresh chain dies on its own. Colours mirror the original tsu/chat.go palette: BLUE/BRIGHT title, TURQUOISE clock + footer, YELLOW topic, RED status line, GREEN history rows + prompt, WHITE underscored input.

Run any TRANSID by typing it at the blank prompt after CSSN sign-on. Refer to runtime/transactions.conf for the full list and ACL configuration.

Built-in transactions (no entry in transactions.conf)

The bricks core dispatches a handful of TRANSIDs directly, without consulting transactions.conf. They take precedence over a same-name entry in the table.

Transid	Purpose	Notes
CSSN	Sign-on	Default authentication flow. Configurable via <code>secure_login_transaction</code> in <code>bricks.cnf</code> .
CSSF	Sign-off	CSSF LOGOFF clears the session's identity; bare CSSF is a no-op.
CEMT	Master-operator	INQUIRE / MONITOR / PERFORM trees; CONTROLBLOCKS sub-tree and PERFORM gated on the <code>admin</code> group.
CEDA	Resource definitions	TRANSACTION / PROGRAM / USER screens; admin-only.
ISPF	Source editor	Browse and edit the REXX, COBOL, and BMS-map source trees. Gated on the <code>dev</code> group. Operator manual: <code>ISPF_editor.md</code> — covers every PF key, every command-line word, every line-prefix command (D / I / C / M / R / U / L /) / (/ X / O / A / B plus the doubled block forms), the file browser, the warn-then-save flow, multi-file editing, and edit locks.

Chapter 29. Worked examples

A. Producer / consumer over a TS queue

PROD writes one item per ENTER from an interactive map; CONS reads with the implicit per-task cursor. PF4 in CONS deletes the queue; PF5 rewinds the cursor by chaining back to itself (RETURN TRANSID('CONS')), so the dispatcher's task-end hook clears the cursor.

```

/* PROD: write one item per ENTER */
ADDRESS CICS
DO FOREVER
  EXEC CICS SEND      MAP('PROD1') FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC
  EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP('PROD1')                      END-EXEC
  IF C2X(EIBAID) = 'F3' THEN EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
  EXEC CICS WRITEQ TS QUEUE(MAP.QNAME) FROM(MAP.PAYLOAD) END-EXEC
END

/* CONS: cursor-advancing read */

```

```

ADDRESS CICS
DO FOREVER
    EXEC CICS SEND      MAP('CONS1') FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC
    EXEC CICS RECEIVE MAP('CONS1')                END-EXEC
    IF C2X(EIBAID) = 'F3' THEN EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC
    EXEC CICS READQ TS QUEUE(QNM) INTO(REC) ITEM(GOTI) END-EXEC
    IF EIBRESP = 26 THEN /* ITEMERR – end of queue */ NOP
END

```

B. SEND TEXT + RECEIVE — no BMS map

GETC takes a customer number from the operator's command line (GETC 100), reads the customers KSDS, and paints the record as free-form text. Because **3270 has no LF**, the body is built as a flat row-major buffer — each logical line padded to the 80-column screen width with LEFT(s,80).

```

/* GETC: lookup-and-display, no map */
ADDRESS CICS
EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(BUF) END-EXEC          /* "GETC 100" */
PARSE VAR BUF TID CKEY .
EXEC CICS READ FILE('customers') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(CKEY) END-EXEC
PARSE VAR REC NM '|' AD '|' CY '|' PH
TXT = LEFT('Customer #' || CKEY, 80)          /* row 0 */
TXT = TXT || LEFT('', 80)                     /* row 1 (blank) */
TXT = TXT || LEFT('Name:   ' || NM, 80)       /* row 2 */
TXT = TXT || LEFT('Address: ' || AD, 80)      /* row 3 */
EXEC CICS SEND TEXT FROM(TXT) ERASE END-EXEC
EXEC CICS RETURN END-EXEC

```

The COBOL companion runtime/cobol/exam.cob shows the same RECEIVE INTO pattern with UNSTRING ... DELIMITED BY ' ' doing the tokenisation:

```

EXEC CICS RECEIVE INTO(WS-INPUT) LENGTH(WS-LEN) END-EXEC
UNSTRING WS-INPUT DELIMITED BY ' '
    INTO WS-TID WS-A WS-B WS-C
END-UNSTRING.

```

C. Browse with GENERIC prefix

A paginated customer list filtered by a 3-character key prefix:

```

EXEC CICS STARTBR FILE('CUSTOMERS')
                RIDFLD('NY-')
                GENERIC KEYLENGTH(3)
END-EXEC
DO FOREVER
    EXEC CICS READNEXT FILE('CUSTOMERS') INTO(REC) RIDFLD(K) END-EXEC
    IF EIBRESP = 20 THEN LEAVE          /* ENDFILE */
    CALL ADD_ROW K, REC
END
EXEC CICS ENDBR FILE('CUSTOMERS') END-EXEC

```


D. Synchronous LINK with COMMAREA

CUST LINKs to CUSV to validate a customer number:

```
SAV = CKEY                                /* in: number to validate */
EXEC CICS LINK PROGRAM('CUSV') COMMAREA(SAV) END-EXEC
PARSE VAR SAV STATUS '|' MSG              /* out: status, message */
IF STATUS <> 'OK' THEN ...
```

CUSV reads DFHCOMMAREA, runs its check, and writes the result back into DFHCOMMAREA before RETURN. The dispatcher hands the final value back to the caller's SAV.

E. Sequential import via READQ TD + WRITE FILE

The ORDR transaction (runtime/cobol/ordr.cob) demonstrates the “text file → VSAM” pattern that the tmp_dir sandbox is built for. The sample data ships in runtime/tmp/orders.sample.txt:

```
C0000001|WIDGET-A|10|19.95
C0000002|WIDGET-B|2|249.00
...
```

The loop body is just two EXEC CICS calls and an UNSTRING:

```
IMPORT-ONE.
  MOVE SPACES TO REC.
  EXEC CICS READQ TD QUEUE('orders.sample.txt') INTO(REC) END-EXEC.
  IF EIBRESP = 12 THEN
    MOVE 'Y' TO DONE-FLAG      *> QZERO -- end of file
  END-IF.
  IF EIBRESP = 0 THEN
    COMPUTE N-READ = N-READ + 1
    MOVE SPACES TO CUST-ID PRODUCT QTY PRICE
    UNSTRING REC DELIMITED BY '|'
      INTO CUST-ID PRODUCT QTY PRICE
    END-UNSTRING
    PERFORM WRITE-ORDER
  END-IF.

WRITE-ORDER.
  MOVE SPACES TO OREC.
  STRING PRODUCT DELIMITED BY SIZE
    '|' DELIMITED BY SIZE
    QTY DELIMITED BY SIZE
    '|' DELIMITED BY SIZE
    PRICE DELIMITED BY SIZE
  INTO OREC
  END-STRING.
  EXEC CICS WRITE FILE('ORDERS') FROM(OREC) RIDFLD(CUST-ID) END-EXEC.
  IF EIBRESP = 0 THEN COMPUTE N-WRITE = N-WRITE + 1 END-IF.
  IF EIBRESP = 14 THEN COMPUTE N-DUP = N-DUP + 1 END-IF.
```

Notes:

- The READQ loop tracks EOF with `EIBRESP = 12 (QZERO)` — the CICS-canonical “queue empty / no more records” signal. The handle is closed automatically at task end.
- `EIBRESP = 14 (DUPREC)` is treated as a counted no-op, not an error: `WRITE FILE` against an existing key fails atomically without overwriting, so a re-run of `ORDR` on the same file is idempotent on the customer-id set.
- `ORDR` ships `public` in `runtime/transactions.conf` so the sample runs out of the box. In a production deployment that imports real data, restrict it to a privileged group (`ORDR:cobol:ordr.cob:admin`) so a casual operator can’t replay the import.
- A REXX equivalent reads the same file via `LINEIN` and writes via `EXEC CICS WRITE`. Because both languages share the `tmp_dir` backend, the sample file works untouched from either side.

Appendix A. Adapting to terminal size (mod 2 vs mod 4)

A 3270 connection negotiates one of several screen models — typically mod 2 (24 - 80) or mod 4 (43 - 80). Bricks captures the size from the telnet/3270 handshake into `session.TCB.Rows/Cols`, and exposes it to programs via `EXEC CICS ASSIGN`:

```
EXEC CICS ASSIGN SCREENHT(SCRH) SCREENWD(SCRW)
                ALTSCRNHT(AH) ALTSCRNWD(AW) END-EXEC
```

`SEND MAP` always passes the negotiated `DevInfo` through to `go3270.ScreenOpts.AltScreen`, so the underlying datastream uses Erase/Write Alternate (`0x7e`) and the terminal clears its full buffer — but a 24-row map painted on a 43-row screen leaves rows 24-42 blank. To use the extra real estate the program has to dispatch to a sized map variant.

Convention

Author one map per model. The mod-2 map keeps its bare name; bigger models add a single-letter suffix:

Model	Suffix	Example map names
mod 2	(none)	HEL01, CUST1, CUST2, CUSTL
mod 3	M	HEL01M, CUST1M, ...
mod 4	L	HEL01L, CUST1L, CUST2L, CUSTLL
mod 5	W	HEL01W, ...

The REXX program builds the suffixed name once and dispatches:

```
EXEC CICS ASSIGN SCREENHT(SCRH) END-EXEC
SUFFIX = ''
IF SCRH >= 43 THEN SUFFIX = 'L'
ELSE IF SCRH >= 32 THEN SUFFIX = 'M'

EXEC CICS SEND MAP('HEL01' || SUFFIX) FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC
IF EIBRESP = 36 THEN DO                /* MAPFAIL - sized variant missing */
```

```
EXEC CICS SEND MAP('HEL01') FROM(SCR.) ERASE END-EXEC
END
```

Three properties make this work without any DSL changes:

1. **Same field names across the family.** `helo1.map` and `helo1l.map` both declare `INFOLINE`, `GREETING`, `FOOTER`. The same `SCR.` stem feeds either one. Bonus tails (e.g. `INF01` / `INF02` / `ACT1` ...) are silently ignored on the smaller map (the renderer only writes values for fields that the map declares).
2. **MAPFAIL fallback.** If the suffixed map isn't on disk, the `SEND` returns `EIBRESP = 36` and the program retries with the bare name — so an operator who deletes `helo1l.map` doesn't break mod-4 connections; they just see the 24-80 layout.
3. **Paging arithmetic adapts at runtime.** `custl.rexx` reads `SCREENHT` and uses `ROWS_PER_PAGE = 35` on mod 4 vs 15 on mod 2, then picks `CUSTLL` vs `CUSTL` accordingly.

Bricks ships sized variants for every map the demo transactions use:

Mod-2 map (24-80)	Mod-4 sibling (43-80)
<code>runtime/map/helo1.map</code>	<code>runtime/map/helo1l.map</code> — adds system-information + recent-activity panes
<code>runtime/map/cust1.map</code> (menu)	<code>runtime/map/cust1l.map</code> — adds recent-activity history
<code>runtime/map/cust2.map</code> (detail)	<code>runtime/map/cust2l.map</code> — adds an audit-log pane
<code>runtime/map/custl.map</code> (15-row list)	<code>runtime/map/custll.map</code> (35-row list)

To see the difference: connect with `c3270 -model 2 localhost 2300` vs. `c3270 -model 4 localhost 2300`, sign on, and run `HELO` or `CUST`. The mod-4 view fills the bottom three-quarters of the screen with extra panels.

Appendix B. Pitfalls and idioms

REXX compound-symbol pitfall

`STEM.tail` with `tail` an *unset* symbol resolves to `STEM.<TAIL>` (a literal tail). With `tail` a *set* symbol it resolves to `STEM.<value-of-tail>` — so reusing a map field name (`OUT.BIRTH = ...` when `BIRTH` is also a local variable) silently writes the wrong tail.

The convention used by `runtime/rexx/cust.rexx` is to give locals distinct names from map fields (`AKT` vs `ACTION`, `CKEY` vs `CUSTNO`, `BSTR` / `NDAYS` vs `BIRTH` / `DAYS`).

COBOL data names across groups

A child name reused across groups is allowed; bare references that match more than one declaration must be qualified with `OF / IN` (`MOVE x OF DET TO y OF SCR`). Bare names that are unique across the program continue to work without qualification. Sibling duplicates within a single group are still rejected at parse time because no qualifier can disambiguate them.

3270 has no LF...obviously.

`SEND TEXT` lays its body out as a flat row-major buffer, every `cols` bytes wrapping to the next row. Programs that expect newline semantics must pad each logical line to the column width (`LEFT(s,80)` in REXX, `PIC X(80)` group children in COBOL) and concatenate.

Kinda obvious, but just making sure it's clear to folks who are new to 3270.

Reset stems before paginated reads

A REXX `STEM.` accumulator that's reused across pages will leak values from the previous page if not dropped. Use `DROP RECS.` (with the trailing dot) at the top of each pagination loop.

EIBAID comparison

In REXX, compare `C2X(EIBAID)` to a hex string: `IF C2X(EIBAID) = 'F3' THEN ...` (PF3). In COBOL, compare `EIBAID` directly to a hex literal: `IF EIBAID = X'F3' ....`

Appendix C. Quick command reference card

A one-page cheat-sheet of every command family. Use the chapter reference for full syntax, options, and condition codes.

EXEC CICS — terminal I/O (Chapter 4)

Command	Purpose
<code>SEND MAP(name) [FROM(stem.)] [ERASE]</code> <code>[CURSOR(p)]</code>	Paint a BMS map; wait for an AID.
<code>RECEIVE MAP(name) [INTO(stem.)]</code>	Pull the operator's response.
<code>CONVERSE MAP(name) FROM(s) INTO(s) [ERASE]</code>	Fused <code>SEND MAP+RECEIVE MAP</code> .
<code>SEND TEXT FROM(buf) [LENGTH(n)] [ERASE]</code>	Free-form row-major output.
<code>RECEIVE INTO(buf) [LENGTH(v)]</code>	Read the operator's command-line tail.

EXEC CICS — program control (Chapter 5)

Command	Purpose
<code>RETURN [TRANSID(id)] [COMMAREA(d)]</code>	End task; optional chain.
<code>XCTL PROGRAM(name) [COMMAREA(d)]</code>	Transfer control.
<code>LINK PROGRAM(name) [COMMAREA(v)]</code>	Synchronous sub-program call.
<code>ABEND [ABCODE(c)]</code>	Abnormal task termination.
<code>START TRANSID(id) [INTERVAL/TIME] [FROM(d)]</code> <code>[TERMID(t)]</code>	Schedule a deferred fire.
<code>RETRIEVE INTO(v) [LENGTH(v)]</code>	Pull the <code>START</code> payload.

EXEC CICS — system services (Chapter 6)

Command	Purpose
ASSIGN <FIELD>(v) ...	Read EIB / environment fields.
ASKTIME [ABSTIME(v)]	Refresh EIBDATE / EIBTIME (+ optional ABSTIME).
FORMATTIME ABSTIME(s) [DATE / TIME / YYYY... / DAYOFWEEK ...]	Decode an ABSTIME.

EXEC CICS — KSDS files (Chapter 7-8)

Command	Purpose
READ FILE(f) INTO(v) RIDFLD(k) [UPDATE]	Exact-key lookup.
WRITE FILE(f) FROM(d) RIDFLD(k)	Insert record.
REWRITE FILE(f) FROM(d)	Replace the READ ... UPDATE record.
DELETE FILE(f) [RIDFLD(k)]	Drop record.
STARTBR FILE(f) [RIDFLD(k)] [GTEQ/EQUAL] [GENERIC KEYLENGTH(n)]	Open browse.
READNEXT FILE(f) INTO(v) [RIDFLD(v)]	Forward one record.
READPREV FILE(f) INTO(v) [RIDFLD(v)]	Backward one record.
RESETBR FILE(f) RIDFLD(k)	Re-position within an open browse.
ENDBR FILE(f)	Close browse.

EXEC CICS — temporary storage / transient data (Chapter 9)

Command	Purpose
READQ TS QUEUE(q) INTO(v) [ITEM(n) NEXT]	Read one TS item.
WRITEQ TS QUEUE(q) FROM(d) [ITEM(n) REWRITE]	Append or rewrite TS item.
DELETEQ TS QUEUE(q)	Drop a TS queue.
READQ TD QUEUE(q) INTO(v)	Read next line from tmp_dir/q.
WRITEQ TD QUEUE(q) FROM(d)	Append line to tmp_dir/q.
DELETEQ TD QUEUE(q)	Delete a TD file.

EXEC CICS — recovery + condition (Chapter 10)

Command	Purpose
SYNCPPOINT	Commit pending unit of work.
SYNCPPOINT ROLLBACK	Undo pending unit of work.
HANDLE CONDITION cond(label) ...	Arm condition trap.
IGNORE CONDITION cond ...	Suppress condition trap.
HANDLE AID key(label) ...	Arm AID-key trap.
HANDLE ABEND LABEL(l) PROGRAM(p) CANCEL RESET	Arm abend exit.

EXEC SQL (Chapter 26)

Command	Purpose
EXEC SQL SELECT cols INTO :v, :v FROM ... END-EXEC	Single-row read; +100 = no-data, -811 = >1 row.
EXEC SQL INSERT INTO t (...) VALUES (...) END-EXEC	Insert.
EXEC SQL UPDATE t SET ... WHERE ... END-EXEC	Update; 0 rows is still NORMAL.
EXEC SQL DELETE FROM t WHERE ... END-EXEC	Delete.
EXEC SQL DECLARE c CURSOR FOR <select> END-EXEC	Declare cursor.
EXEC SQL OPEN c END-EXEC	Open cursor.
EXEC SQL FETCH c INTO :v, :v END-EXEC	Next row; +100 at end.
EXEC SQL CLOSE c END-EXEC	Close cursor.
EXEC SQL COMMIT WORK END-EXEC / ROLLBACK WORK	Transaction control.
EXEC SQL CONNECT TO 'db' END-EXEC	Per-task database switch.
EXEC SQL WHENEVER {SQLERROR NOT FOUND SQLWARNING} {CONTINUE GO TO label} END-EXEC	Declarative error handler.

EXEC CICS WEB — server side (Phase 1)

Command	Purpose
WEB EXTRACT METHOD(v) PATH(v) HOST(v) PORT(v) SCHEME(v) QUERYSTRING(v) ...	Inbound request meta.
WEB EXTRACT CERTIFICATE COMMONNAME(v) ORGANISATION(v) COUNTRY(v) SERIALNUM(v) ISSUER(v)	mTLS peer-cert fields.
WEB EXTRACT TCIPSERVICE(v) PORTNUMBER(v) IPADDRESS(v) CLIENT(v) AUTHENTICATE(v)	Listener inspection.
WEB READ HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(v) [LENGTH(v)]	Inbound header by name.
WEB STARTBROWSE / READNEXT / ENDBROWSE HTTPHEADER	Walk inbound headers.
WEB READ QUERYPARM(name) VALUE(v)	Query parameter / path capture.
WEB STARTBROWSE / READNEXT / ENDBROWSE QUERYPARM	Walk parameters.
WEB READ FORMFIELD(name) VALUE(v)	Form-encoded field.
WEB STARTBROWSE / READNEXT / ENDBROWSE FORMFIELD	Walk form fields.
WEB RECEIVE INTO(v) [MAXLENGTH(n)] [LENGTH(v)] [MEDIATYPE(v)] [TYPE(v)]	Read raw request body.
WEB WRITE HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(v)	Set outbound response header.
WEB SEND FROM(buf) [MEDIATYPE(s)] [STATUSCODE(n)]	Emit response.

Command	Purpose
WEB PARSE URL URL(s) SCHEMENAME(v) HOST(v) PORT(v) PATH(v) QUERYSTRING(v)	URL splitter.
WEB CONVERTTIME DATESTRING(s) ABSTIME(v)	RFC 1123 / 850 / asctime → ABSTIME.
WEB RETRIEVE DOCTOKEN(v)	Inbound body as DOCUMENT.

EXEC CICS WEB — client side (Phase 2)

Command	Purpose
WEB OPEN HOST(s) [PORT(n)] [SCHEME(s)] SESSTOKEN(v)	Open client session.
WEB OPEN URIMAP(name) SESSTOKEN(v)	Open via URIMAP.
WEB CONVERSE SESSTOKEN(t) METHOD(m) PATH(p) [FROM(b)] INTO(v) [STATUSCODE(v)] CONVERSE WEB ...	One-shot send + receive. Alias for WEB CONVERSE.
WEB SEND SESSTOKEN(t) METHOD(m) PATH(p) [FROM(b)] [QUERYSTRING(s)] [MEDIATYPE(s)]	Stage request.
WEB SEND URIMAP(name) METHOD(m) PATH(p) ... INTO(v)	One-shot via URIMAP.
WEB RECEIVE SESSTOKEN(t) INTO(v) [STATUSCODE(v)] [MEDIATYPE(v)] [MAXLENGTH(n)]	Fire staged request.
WEB CLOSE SESSTOKEN(t)	Release session.
WEB WRITE HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(v) SESSTOKEN(t)	Set outbound <i>request</i> header.
WEB READ HTTPHEADER(name) VALUE(v) [LENGTH(v)] SESSTOKEN(t)	Read response header.
WEB STARTBROWSE / READNEXT / ENDBROWSE HTTPHEADER SESSTOKEN(t)	Walk response headers.
WEB EXTRACT SESSTOKEN(t) [SCHEME(v)] [HOST(v)] [PORT(v)] [PATH(v)]	Inspect session endpoint.
WEB EXTRACT URIMAP(name) [SCHEME(v)] [HOST(v)] [PORT(v)] [PATH(v)]	Inspect URIMAP entry.

EXEC CICS DOCUMENT

Command	Purpose
DOCUMENT CREATE DOCTOKEN(v) [SYMBOLLIST(s)] [LISTLENGTH(n)] [DELIMITER(s)]	New empty document.
DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(t) FROM(b) [LENGTH(n)] [AT(pos)]	Append / splice bytes.
DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(t) SYMBOL(name)	Substitute from symbol list.
DOCUMENT INSERT DOCTOKEN(t) DOCUMENT(other-tok) [AT(pos)]	Splice another document.

Command	Purpose
DOCUMENT SET DOCTOKEN(t) SYMBOLLIST(s) [DELIMITER(d)]	Re-bind symbol list.
DOCUMENT RETRIEVE DOCTOKEN(t) INTO(b) LENGTH(v)	Read assembled body.
DOCUMENT DELETE DOCTOKEN(t)	Release document.
WEB SEND DOCTOKEN(t) [STATUSCODE(n)] [MEDIATYPE(s)]	Emit document as response.

Standard copybooks

Copybook	Brings in
DFHAID	AID byte constants (ENTER, PF03, PA1, ...) and their DFH... aliases.
DFHRESP	EIBRESP condition constants (RESP-NORMAL / DFHRESP-NORMAL, etc.).
SQLCA	SQLCODE + SQLSTATE constants (SQL-OK, SQLSTATE-DUP-KEY, ...).
DFHWBSC	HTTP status codes (DFHRESP-WB-OK, ...).
DFHWBUH	Common header-name literals (WB-CONTENT-TYPE, ...).
DFHWBMT	MIME-type literals (WB-MT-JSON, ...).
DFHWBMETH	HTTP method literals (WB-GET, WB-POST, ...).
DFHWBSI	Session-token + body buffer templates.
DFHWBUM	URIMAP record fields.
DFHWBHB	Header-browse helpers (DFH-WB-HDR-NAME, ...).
DFHWBCC	TLS / mTLS cert-extract pack.
DFHDCDOC	DOCUMENT token + delimiter constants.

EIB fields (Chapter 11)

Field	Set by	Meaning
EIBAID	SEND MAP / RECEIVE MAP	AID byte.
EIBCPOSN	SEND MAP / RECEIVE MAP	1-based cursor position.
EIBCALEN	dispatcher entry	DFHCOMMAREA length.
EIBTRMID	dispatcher	Terminal ID.
EIBRESP / EIBRESP2	every EXEC CICS	Response code + secondary.
EIBDATE / EIBTIME	ASKTIME	0CYYDDD / HHMMSS.
EIBABCODE	abend trap	4-char abend code.
RC	every EXEC CICS	Mirror of EIBRESP.

SQLCA fields (Chapter 26)

Field	Type	Meaning
SQLCODE	PIC S9(9)	0 = OK, +100 = no-data, -N = error.
SQLSTATE	PIC X(5)	5-character ISO state code.
SQLERRMC	PIC X(70)	Human-readable PG error text.
SQLERRD3	PIC S9(9)	Rows-affected count after INSERT / UPDATE / DELETE.
SQLWARN0	PIC X(1)	'W' if any warning fired (Bricks rarely sets).

End of publication.